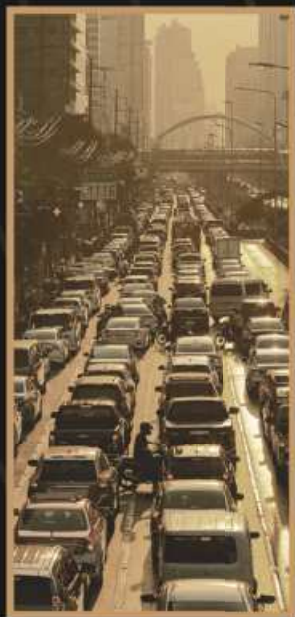


CHENNAI, IDHU UNGALUKKANA REVOLUTION



Today...
Lives have tightened.
Homes have shrunk into pigeonholes.
Between concrete, traffic and pollution
peace slipped away.
The city kept expanding.
But our lives kept shrinking.
Less laughter. Less play. Less living.

But what if...
Space came back?
Green found its way home?
Children had room to run again?
And families... had time to just be?

This isn't just an upgrade.
This is reclaiming what the city took away.
This is a revolution where life expands again.

THIS IS **CASAGRAN**
HIGHCITY ON ORR

LAUNCHING

CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR

HIGHCITY

LUXURIOUS 2 & 3 BHK APTS. FROM JUST ₹49L - ₹67L*
[THIS PRICE IS FOR FIRST 25 BOOKINGS ONLY]



MASTER CRAFTED BY A GLOBAL VISIONARY

- 41-acre mega township
- Designed by Mr. Wong Chiu Man (WOW Architects, Singapore)
- Unfolding into 22-floor towers and 4,000+ homes



WHERE LIFE IS RULED BY NATURE

- 28 acres of open space
- 22-acre lush greenery that includes 10-acre nature zones
- One-of-a-kind 3.5-acre tropical forest



EXPANSIVE HOMES THAT MAKE A STATEMENT

- 73% carpet area efficiency & uninterrupted scenic views
- Convertible balconies with 3x light & ventilation
- American designed CP & sanitary fittings



THE APEX OF BLISS & LEISURE

- 163 world-class amenities with 25+ exclusive for kids
- 21,000 sft. resort-style aquatic paradise with 3 swimming pools including an olympic-size
- Lavish 1.3-acre recreational clubhouse



A FULFILLING ECOSYSTEM

- Casagrand International School within the community
- Co-working spaces, EV charging, car wash bay & more
- Casagrand curated community events, festivals and social experiences



SPORTING AMBITION TAKES ROOT & RISES

- India's largest 5-acre sports clubhouse
- 35+ sports courts built to global standards
- Lifetime premium membership for residents

CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR



THE REVOLUTIONARY LOCATION

THE ONLY PLACE CONNECTED TO ANNA NAGAR, T. NAGAR & ADYAR WITHIN 40 MINS

PORUR
30 MINS

VADAPALANI
35 MINS

ANNA NAGAR
40 MINS

AIRPORT
15 MINS

PALLAVARAM
20 MINS

KATHIPARA
35 MINS

T. NAGAR
40 MINS

SHOLINGANALLUR
30 MINS

VELACHERY
30 MINS

ADYAR
40 MINS

THE REVOLUTIONARY PRICE

PRICED BEST AMONG THE NEIGHBOURHOODS

TAMBARAM
MARKET PRICE ₹7000/SFT.

PALLAVARAM
MARKET PRICE ₹8000/SFT.

PORUR
MARKET PRICE ₹9000/SFT.

VELACHERY
MARKET PRICE ₹10000/SFT.

HIGHCITY
LAUNCH PRICE ₹3899/SFT.

EARLY BIRD
PRICE ₹3699/SFT.
(FIRST 25 BOOKINGS)

₹3799/SFT.
(26 - 50 BOOKINGS)

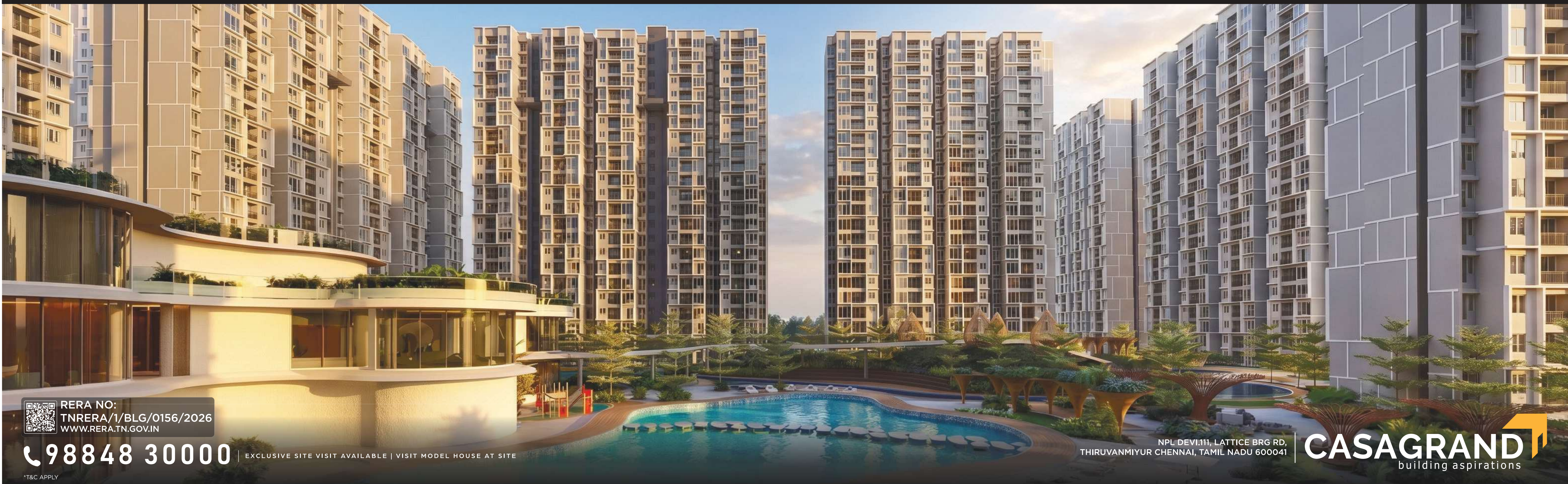
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(51 - 100 BOOKINGS)

*BOOK TODAY, TO AVAIL THE BEST EARLY BIRD PRICE!

TYPE	SIZE	LAUNCH PRICE	EARLY BIRD PRICE
2 BHK	1109 SFT.	₹54L	₹49L
3 BHK	1284 - 1636 SFT.	₹57L - ₹70L	₹55L - ₹67L

PHASE-I TOTAL UNITS: 1099 | SOLD: 329 | AVAILABLE: 770

HANDOVER IN 36 MONTHS



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TNRERA/1/BLG/0156/2026
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THIRUVANMIYUR CHENNAI, TAMIL NADU 600041

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building aspirations

LAUNCHING

CASAGRANDBANG ON ORR

HIGHCITY

LUXURIOUS 2 & 3 BHK APTS. FROM JUST ₹49L - ₹67L*



SWIMMING POOL

ENTERTAINMENT & FEATURES

- SPORTS**

Cricket practice net, multipurpose court, half basketball court, pickle ball court, badminton court, woodland fitness, fitness recharge pod & active loop
- KIDS**

Rock climbing wall, toddler play area, Little pine play arena, sunbeam pavilion, hidden wonderland, adventure play lawn play pavilion, hilltop play zone & more...
- SWIMMING POOL**

Adult swimming pool (25m lap), kid's splash pool, kid's shallow play pool, jacuzzi leisure pool, lazy pool, dancing waters, island cabana, poolside meditation deck, poolside patio, in-water loungers, aqua trail & more...
- ENTERTAINMENT**

Sunken lawn, lantern court with BBQ pods, party pavilion, makers' market, the pop-up plaza & riverside nook
- FEATURES**

Multipurpose lawn, bus bay with halt zone, drop off plaza, elevated family deck, sky nest, treetop walk, senior citizen alcove, mirror pool, water feature with boulders & more...
- THEMED GARDENS**

Foliage court, community gardens, fragrant grove, woodland meadows, herb, spice & edible garden

163
REVOLUTIONARY
AMENITIES

CLUBHOUSE AMENITIES

- ENTERTAINMENT & CONVENIENCE**

Central atrium with seating, double height banquet hall, serene lounge, multipurpose hall, mini theatre, learning centre, reading pods, scholar's lounge, reading nook, business centre & more...
- KIDS PLAY AREA & CRECHE**

Rainbow ball pool, soft fall mounds, explorers toy wall, cribs, mini trampoline, pause & play court, little artists' corner, magnetic dart board, mini basketball hoop, velcro wall, little builders' zone & more...
- INDOOR GAMES ROOM**

Video gaming console, air hockey, foosball, snooker, table tennis, VR duo & subsoccer tablet
- FEATURES & FACILITIES**

Convenience store, FMS room & association room, guest room, car washing bay & car charging bays
- ROOFTOP**

Sky deck, skyline café, zen terrace, vista seater & pebble lounge
- & 50+ IN THE SPORTS CLUB**
- 

SCAN TO EXPERIENCE
VIRTUAL WALKTHROUGH



RECREATIONAL CLUBHOUSE



ELEVATED WALKWAY



CLUBHOUSE LOBBY

- India's largest sports club on 5 acres, designed for 12 different sports
- 50+ amenities for wellness & an active lifestyle
- 35+ sports courts built to global standards
- Lifetime premium membership for residents
- Exclusive sports courts for futsal (7-a side), badminton & pickleball
- Elite recreational sports like bowling alley, squash, tennis, basketball & box cricket
- Indoor gaming zones with billiard, table tennis, board games
- Spa & wellness zone with a gym, sauna, steam, salon, therapy rooms & jacuzzi

INDIA'S
REVOLUTIONARY
SPORTS CLUBHOUSE

- Water retreats for every age with an indoor, Olympic-size, kids pool & a pool bar
- Curated dining experience with a restaurant, juice bar, sports bar & refreshment corner
- Rooftop cabanas & sky bar for elevated leisure
- Signature lounges for relaxation, recreation & socialising
- Elegant celebration venues with banquet hall, pre-function area and leisure lawn
- Convenience amenities like guest suites, business centre, medical centre & more
- Vibrant community spaces like viewing gallery, courtyard garden & central plaza

WHY
CASAGRAND?

*T&C APPLY

No.1
Ranked in Chennai
for last 8 years*

Top 2
Ranked in
South India

Top 7
Ranked in
India

22+ years
of Trust &
Legacy

7000+
Homes sold in
FY'24 - 25

6 Cities
Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad,
Pune, Coimbatore & Dubai

2 months
Guaranteed rental

6 months
Guaranteed resale

7 years
Warranty

10 years
Maintenance by us

2000+
Quality checks

On-time
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CASAGRANDBuilding aspirations

*Based on CBRE report 2024
Casagrand Premier Builder Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offer of its equity shares and has filed a draft red herring prospectus ("DRHP") with the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"). The DRHP is available on the website of our Company, at www.casagrand.co.in, the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the websites of the book running lead managers Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited and DAM Capital Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswalgroup.com and www.damcapital.in respectively, and the websites of the stock exchange(s) at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, respectively. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see "Risk Factors" of the RHP, when available. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI for making any investment decision. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended ("U.S. Securities Act") or any other applicable law of the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold outside the United States in "offshore transactions" as defined in and in compliance with Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur.

INBRIEF



Over 42,000 registrations received for TNEA 2026 so far

A total of 42,156 applications have been received till Thursday from students seeking admission under the Tamil Nadu Engineering Admissions (TNEA) 2026 since the portal opened on May 3, a press release from the Directorate of Technical Education said. Out of them, 10,423 candidates had completed the payment of necessary fees for the admission process, and 3,352 of them had completed uploading their certificates.

Sri Nithyakalyana Perumal Temple car festival held

The annual car festival of the Sri Nithyakalyana Perumal Temple was held at Thiruvudanthai on East Coast Road on Thursday morning as part of the *Chithirai Peruvizha*, the *brahmotsavam*. The *utsava* idols of Sri Nithyakalyana Perumal along with Sridevi and Sri Bhudevi were brought out on procession by 10 a.m. A large number of local residents participated in the festival.

In 4 months, T.N. records 2.63 lakh dog bites, 17 rabies deaths

Serena Josephine M.
CHENNAI

The numbers tell a troubling story in Tamil Nadu this year. In just four months of 2026, the State has recorded 2.63 lakh dog bite cases and 17 deaths from rabies, a substantial share of last year's 6.25 lakh bites and half of last year's 34 deaths.

Data from the Directorate of Public Health (DPH) and Preventive Medicine show 62,000 dog bite cases, each in January and February, rising to 71,000 in March, and dipping slight-

ly to 68,000 in April. Dog bites continue to be a growing concern across the State, with Chennai, Salem, Tiruchi, and Dindigul among the districts reporting higher numbers. There have been repeated calls for sustained measures to control the stray dog population, strengthen Animal Birth Control (ABC) programme, and improve rabies vaccination coverage among dogs.

A. Somasundaram, Director of Public Health and Preventive Medicine, said cases had marginally increased in the State.



With the stray dog population on the rise, experts say ABC measures and vaccination of dogs remain a challenge.

“There is no specific treatment or medication for rabies, and it is 100% fatal. This is a challenge. The only tool to prevent rabies is vaccination,” he said. Awareness on anti-rabies vaccination is better and

compliance has improved, he added.

“The Health Department focuses on proper wound washing, administration of Anti-Rabies Vaccine, and rabies immunoglobulin based on the categorisation of bites. Wound washing plays a crucial role,” he said.

With the stray dog population on the rise, experts say ABC measures and vaccination of dogs against rabies continue to be challenging. “Veterinarians, with the help of local bodies, need to vaccinate dogs, while ABC measures

should be undertaken by local bodies,” an official said.

Defaulter tracing

On its part, the DPH is intensifying defaulter tracing. “We are tracking people who take the first dose of the vaccine to ensure that they complete the course. There also needs to be greater awareness on safeguarding children and not leaving them unattended outdoors. Many believe nothing will happen if pet dogs bite but it is important to understand that anti-rabies vaccination is

required,” Dr. Somasundaram said.

S. Chandrasekar, professor and head, Department of Medicine, Government Stanley Medical College Hospital, also stressed the need to protect children, who are more vulnerable. “No animal bite should be ignored. Prevention is key. It is important to go to the nearest health facility and get vaccinated. In Category III bites (transdermal bites or scratches, licks on broken skin), rabies immunoglobulin should be administered,” Dr.

‘There is potential for India and Sri Lanka to work together in higher education’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

There is immense potential for India and Sri Lanka to work together in higher education, research, skill development, and technology-driven innovation, which would benefit our youth, said Ganesanathan Geathiswaran, Deputy High Commissioner, Sri Lanka Deputy High Commission, on Thursday in Chennai at the third edition of the Tamil Nadu Higher Education Summit 2026.

The day-long summit themed ‘Empowering the Future Workforce: AI, AVGC & Industry 4.0 in Academia’ discussed the global impact of artificial intelligence, necessity of industry-academia collaborations, emerging technological disruptions, and the evolving start-up ecosystem. It was organised by the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) Tamil Nadu State Council.

Speaking at the summit, Ashok G. Verghese, co-chairman, FICCI TN State Council and pro-chancellor, Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science, said: “The future of higher education cannot be shaped by old models in a rapidly evolving world. Now, we must move faster and work together, the future of the workforce demands more than degrees. It requires digital skills, creativity, problem solving, and communications.”

The FICCI Industry Collaboration Award-Excellence in Global Aviation Training Standards was presented to Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science and Orient Flights Private Limited. The FICCI Industry Collaboration Award-Emerging Technologies and Innovation was given to the Indian Institute of Technology-Madras, and the FICCI Industry Collaboration Award-Excellence in Quantum Computing and Advance Technologies was presented to IIT-M and IBM. G.S.K. Velu, Chairman, FICCI Tamil Nadu State council and CMD, Trivitron Healthcare and Neuberg Diagnostics Group, also spoke.

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Government of Karnataka
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6th Floor, 2nd Stage, M.S. Building, Ambedkar Veedhi, Bangalore-560 001.
No. ED/12/KVV/2026 Date: 06.05.2026
PUBLIC NOTIFICATION
Selection to the Post of Vice-Chancellor of Kannada University, Hampi
Invitation of application for the post of Vice-Chancellor of Kannada University, Hampi
The Department of Higher Education, Govt of Karnataka invites Applications from eligible Professors/Educationists for the post of Vice-Chancellor of Kannada University, Hampi in accordance with the provisions of Section 13(2) of the Kannada University Act, 1991. Applications should be submitted within 20 days from the date of this notification to "The Secretary to Government, Dept of Higher Education, 6th Floor, Multi-Storeyed Building, Bengaluru - 560001". Email: kannadaunivc2026@gmail.com. The detailed application form and other details are available on Higher Education Department website <https://hed.karnataka.gov.in>.
Sd/-
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Department of Higher Education
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SOUTHERN RAILWAY
(CONSTRUCTION / ROAD SAFETY PROJECTS)
E-Tender Notice No. CAO-CN-RSP-ROB-2-2026, DATED: 04.05.2026
For and on behalf of The President of India, The Deputy Chief Engineer, Construction, Road Safety Projects, Southern Railway, Egmore, Chennai 600 008 invites e-tender for the following work(s) as per Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) in our portal www.ireps.gov.in. The tenders/Contractors intending to apply for the tender needs to get enrolled in the portal www.ireps.gov.in and only online tenders will be accepted.

Sl. No.	Name of the work
1	Tender No: CAO-CN-RSP-ROB-2-2026 1. MAS Division - AJJ - JTJ section- Proposed 1 x 7.0 x 3.6m RCC Pre-cast box subway at km 145/200-300 in lieu of existing LC No: 61 between Latteri and Kavarur stations (Air Push Method) 2. MAS Division - Proposed 1 x 7.7 x 4.0m Pre-cast RCC box subway in lieu of existing LC No: 70 at km 165/400-500 between Valathoor and Melpalai stations (Air Push Method) 3. MAS Division - AJJ - JTJ section - Proposed 1 x 7.70 x 3.6m Pre-cast RCC box subway at km 166/900 in lieu of existing LC No: 71 at km 167/0-100 between Valathoor and Melpalai stations (Air Push Method) 4. MAS Division - AJJ - JTJ section - Proposed 1 x 7.00m x 3.66m RCC Pre-cast box subway in lieu of existing LC No: 74 at km 172/300-400 between Melpalai and Pachchakkuppam stations (Air Push Method); Cash Value (₹) : 178712668; Closing Date and Time: 27.05.2026 at 15.00 hrs.
2	Tender No: CAO-CN-RSP-ROB-03-2026 Proposed 2 Lane Road Over Bridge in lieu of LC No.376 along with LUS at Km 455/800-900, 1 x 42.0m steel Bow string girder between Vellannur and Pudukottai Stations; Cash Value (₹) : 115951223; Closing Date and Time: 27.05.2026 at 15.00 hrs.
3	Tender No: CAO-CN-RSP-ROB-04-2026 Proposed Road Over Bridge in lieu of Exg. LC No.16 at km19/100 1 x 44m EFF span steel Composite Girder near Pasur Railway Station Yard.; Cash Value (₹) : 104992855; Closing Date and Time: 27.05.2026 at15.00 hrs.
4	Tender No: CAO-CN-RSP-ROB-05-2026 SALEM DIVISION - Proposed Construction of Road Over Bridge at Rilykm 7/100-200 in Lieu of Existing LC no. 4 at KM 6/800-900 between Coimbatore North and Karamadai Stations in Coimbatore - Mettupalayam Section) along with Pedestrian Subway; Cash Value (₹) : 211877669; Closing Date and Time: 27.05.2026 at 15.00 hrs.
5	Tender No: CAO-CN-RSP-ROB-6-2026 MDU Division - VPT - MEJ section - Proposed Construction of Road Over Bridge in lieu of existing LC No: 424 at km 565/100-200 with 1x42m clear span steel bowstring girder between Sattur and Nail station along with limited use subway; Cash Value (₹) : 148066898; Closing Date and Time: 27.05.2026 at 15.00 hrs.

For further details, please refer to website portal www.ireps.gov.in or contact Office of the Chief Administrative Officer, Construction, Road Safety Projects, Southern Railway, E.V.R. High Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008.
Deputy Chief Engineer, Construction, Road Safety Projects, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008.

INBRIEF



GCC acts on complaints from Meenakshi Nagar in Porur

Nearly a month after residents flagged stalled civic works in Meenakshi Nagar, Porur, authorities carried out partial restoration works on Thursday. Residents had complained on April 10 about open trenches and safety risks due to lack of proper barricades. Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) said that necessary action had been taken, including completion of stormwater drain works in the locality.

Structure erected for polls removed weeks after voting

Following complaints from the public, the civic officials on Thursday removed a stage erected for the election in front of a hardware shop in M.G.R Nagar. Residents said that the stage on K.K. Salai was left unattended for weeks. Later in the day, Greater Chennai Corporation confirmed that the encroachments in the area had been removed.

Corporation carries out stray cattle raid in Arumbakkam

GCC carried out a cattle raid in Arumbakkam after locals complained of stray cattle menace near Chennai Middle School in Jai Nagar.

Phase-I of Guindy Eco-Park to be completed by Oct. 2026

A pathway with compacted mud, a bicycle track, parking space, and amenities for visitors are among the works to be carried out at a cost of ₹37.85 crore by the State Horticulture Department

ECO WATCH

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

The Department of Horticulture and Plantation Crops is in the process of transforming one of the most famous landmarks in the city - the Guindy Race Course.

The place where horses and their jockeys made or broke fortunes is quietly shaping into an eco-park that even while under construction is an isle of peace and quiet amid the city's hustle and bustle.

New waterbodies

The first phase of the project is being carried out on the 118-acre land, where the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) has created four ponds and deepened two lakes.

It has also created bio-swales, which are channels that allow the flow of rain-water that will be filtered by plants and natural vegetation throughout the boundary of the park. These are meant to



Work apace: The first phase of the project is being carried out on the 118-acre Guindy Race Course land, where the GCC has created four ponds and deepened two lakes. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

let the water percolate into the ground and also prevent flooding in the locality.

"A viewing point from the highest spot at the centre will be created from where the entire park would be visible. A bridge is being constructed to reach the man-made island inside the other lake. There are three islands inside the waterbodies," explained a source associated with the project.

Among the other fea-

tures planned in the first phase are a pathway with compacted mud, a bicycle track, parking space and visitor amenities on about 25 acres of land that is expected to be completed by October this year at a cost of ₹37.85 crore, explained a source in the department.

Tree planting

Avenue tree planting has been carried out along internal pathways, with 495 trees planted across a 2.5-kilometre stretch. The

plantations include native and ornamental species such as *Magizham*, *Shenbagham*, *Nagalingam*, *Kadambam*, *Punnai*, *Pungan*, *Naval*, and *Tabeba*.

In addition to tree planting, bund strengthening around water bodies and the establishment of a nursery for plant propagation have been initiated. The park also has a nursery selling seeds, saplings and plants, and gardening needs at affordable prices. The nursery also sells herbal plants and seedlings of vegetable plants.

In the upcoming phases, the project envisages the development of herbal gardens highlighting traditional Siddha medicinal plants, offering educational opportunities on indigenous knowledge systems.

Waterfront landscapes will form an integral part of the park experience. Natural lake edges, wetlands, and bird habitat islands are planned to create thriving ecosystems within the park, while also providing serene spaces for visitors to relax and observe nature.

Government seeks postponement of DGP empanelment committee meeting

S. Vijay Kumar
CHENNAI

The appointment of a regular Director General of Police (DGP) and Head of the Police Force in the Tamil Nadu police is set to be delayed further. The State government has written to the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) requesting postponement of the Empanelment Committee Meeting (ECM) which was scheduled in Delhi on May 11. In a communication sent to the UPSC, the State said the presence of the Chief Secretary and the Home Secretary in the State was absolutely essential in the next few days.

Political developments

Apparently referring to the ongoing political developments, a top official requested UPSC to postpone the meeting to some other date, preferably in the last week of May.

The present DGP/HoPF Sandeep Rai Rathore, who was appointed by the Election Commission of India replacing G. Venkatraman who was in-charge of the

post, would continue to head the force till a UPSC-empanelled chief of police is appointed as per the Supreme Court guidelines in the Prakash Singh case, police sources said on Thursday. The ECM convened by UPSC is led by its chairman, the Union Home Secretary, the DGP of one of the Central Armed Paramilitary Forces (not belonging to the Tamil Nadu cadre), the Chief Secretary and Home Secretary of the State concerned. This is the third time that the ECM is being postponed. First it was convened on March 20, and was deferred due to administrative reasons, and then on April 23 since it was polling day for the Assembly election.

The DGP-rank officers who would be considered for empanelment in the order of seniority are Seema Agrawal, Rajeev Kumar and Sandeep Rai Rathore followed by G. Vannia Perumal, Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal, G. Venkatraman and others. Ms. Agrawal is due to retire from service next month, the sources said.

Work to construct additional permanent DPCs in Tiruvallur nears completion



Farmers said the DPCs in the area need a drying machine.

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Work to construct additional direct procurement centres (DPCs) for paddy is nearing completion in Tiruvallur district, which already has over 30 permanent DPCs. Each centre will have a ware-

house to store 2,000 bags at a time, an open space with cement flooring to pack the bags, a weighing machine, and a winnowing machine to remove impurities.

"The Agriculture department and the District Rural Development Agency is constructing the per-

manent DPCs. Farmers want DPCs in all the 700-odd revenue villages. We are prioritising villages where more farmers bring in a higher quantity of paddy for the permanent centres. More permanent DPCs would be constructed in a phased manner," said Dis-

trict Collector M. Prathap. "Since the safety of the paddy procured is of utmost importance, it has been our practice to have seasonal DPCs in government buildings like panchayat offices, SHG buildings, community halls, and godowns belonging to other departments. When the

DPCs are opened, we also make plans for transporting the paddy to mills and large warehouses," he added.

M. Krishnatesan, a farmer from Krishnasamudram in Tiruttani, said that opening a new DPC in their area was a welcome move. "The storage space, however,

needs to be expanded. It can only store 2,000 bags. But the farmers here sell 950-1,000 bags a day. We need more space to pack the bags as well. A drying machine would do well at DPCs since moisture content is an issue at all the centres. Currently, paddy has to be sent to the hulling

mills to be dried," he said.

Thanigaivel Kalathi, a farmer, said a new DPC constructed at the other end of Cooum village was 3 km away from where the majority of fields were located.

"Local politicians chose that spot as it is closer to their lands," he claimed.

Police step up security at Marina beach over possible TVK protests

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The city police tightened security around Marina beach and adjoining areas on Thursday, cordoning-off key entry and exit points with iron barricades following reports that supporters of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) could gather there to stage protests over the delay in the formation of a new government.

At least 50 police personnel and six patrol vehicles were deployed along Loop Road off Kamarajar Salai, while barricades were placed on roads leading to the beach. In the forenoon, the police dispersed small groups that had gathered near the area and asked the public to vacate the spot.

The TVK secured a victory in 108 of the 234 Assembly constituencies, and emerged as the single largest party in the Assembly election held on April 23.

Although party president C. Joseph Vijay submitted a list of 112 MLAs, including five from the Congress, to Governor Rajendra Viswanath Arlekar on Wednesday, he is yet to be invited to form the new government.

Law and order

A senior police officer said security had been strengthened at the beach area to prevent gatherings and ensure that there were no law and order issues.

CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras Today: From 6.00 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall - Narayanatirtha Compositions - Dr. Sumithra Vasude (Vocal), Dr. Usha Rajagopalan (Violin), B. Ganapathyraman (Mridangam) - Programme under the endowment instituted by Late Sri. P. Obul Reddy & Smt. P. Gnanamba.

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Dr.Nali Gana Vihar,T.Nagar, Ph:28140806
SUMMER DRAMA FEST 2026:
TODAY : 08.05.26: 7.00 P.M.: FATHIMA BABU FAB'S THEATRE PRESENTS 'UN KANNIL NEER VAZHINDHAL' STORY & DIALOGUES : T.V.RADHAKRISHNAN
DIRECTION: FATHIMA BABU
TOMORROW: 09.05.26: 4.30 P.M.: DUMMIES DRAMA PRESENTS 'THANIMAI' BY NITHYAKAUSHIK
7.00 P.M.: DUMMIES DRAMA PRESENTS 'MR.STRANGER' WRITTEN & DIRECTED BY V.SREEVATHSON
TICKETS AVAILABLE AT :
bookmyshow & SABHA OFFICE
CAFÉ: SATVA
VALET PARKING AVAILABLE
Powered by : Nalli

Sri Thyaga Brahma Gana Sabha (Regd) Vanimahala, Ph: 28152166
Today 6.30pm at Vani Mahal Komal Theatres presents Sivasankari's short stories on stage "SIVASANKARI", Dramatization & Direction by Ms. Dhariini Komal. All are welcome.

MISCELLANEOUS

Rukmini Trust, 24992672
Today 6.15pm Varalakshmi Anandkumar, M. Vijay, Adharsh Devarajan. Ragasudha Hall.

CHINMAYA MISSION CHENNAI
On 8th May 2026
Kamban Tarum Katchi
AI version show at 6.30 p.m.
On 10th May 2026
Sadhu Sangam
Talk on
Geeta Gyana Yagna Pracharakaya Namah by revered Swamijis from various organisations.
Venue : "TAPOVAN HALL", Chinmaya Heritage Centre, No.2, 13th Avenue, Harrington Road, Chetpet, Chennai - 600031.
All are welcome

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Notice Inviting Bid
Bid for Purchase of Silicon rubber hosed composite insulators (400 kV Suspension (120KN- 2074 Nos) under BN-9018002603 (UBN: VPN2672GLOB00309) is invited from interested bidders up to 04:00 PM on 29.05.2026.
Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.raj.nic.in>) of the state; and <http://energy.rajjasthan.gov.in/rvpnl> departmental website.
Raj.Samwad/C/26/2235 RRVPN/TR-7547/2026
Superintending Engineer (Contracts-I), Jaipur

KSEB KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE
O/o The Chief Engineer, (S.C.M) & C.S.C., Vidyuthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram.
GeM Bid No. GEM/2026/B/735025, Dtd: 19.03.2026, PAC: Rs. 3,92,95,640/-, Last Date: 20.05.2026, 4.00 pm.
GeM Bid No. GEM/2026/B/7354688, Dtd: 19.03.2026, PAC: Rs. 1,40,21,100/-, Last Date: 20.05.2026, 4.00 pm.
E-Tender ID No. 2026_KSEB_848551_1, PAC: Rs. 2,46,88,100/-, Last Date: 20.05.2026, 03.00 pm.
E-Tender ID No. 2026_KSEB_849176_1, PAC: Rs. 8,97,42,000/-, Last Date: 27.05.2026, 03.00 pm.
E-Tender ID No. 2026_KSEB_848774_1, PAC: Rs. 3,79,37,520/-, Last Date: 25.05.2026, 05.00 pm.
E-Tender ID No. 2026_KSEB_848755_1, PAC: Rs. 2,45,64,650/-, Last Date: 03.06.2026, 04.30 pm.
E-Tender ID No. 2026_KSEB_849052_1, PAC: Rs. 28,26,88,200/-, Last Date: 12.06.2026, 04.00 pm.
Visit www.etenders.kerala.gov.in and www.kseb.in
Ref: PR/IMC1/E611 - E-tender/2026

Bangalore Electricity Supply Company Limited
(Wholly owned Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN: U04010KA20025GC030438)
NOTIFICATION INVITING TENDER (Through KPP Portal)
BESCOM invites Tender for the following work: Tender Enquiry No: BESCOM/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT1081. Description of work: "Automation of NON DAS Feeders in BMAZ area, BESCOM". Availability of Bid document: On or after 13.05.2026. The detailed notification can be obtained from the Website: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.
Sd/- The General Manager (DAS), BICC-1, 17th Cross, 24th Main, HSR Layout 2nd Sector, Bengaluru-560102.
For Electricity related complaints call: 1912
Download BESCOM Mithra Mobile APP

F.No.A.-2024/1/2024-EJV
Government of India
Ministry of Jal Shakti
Department of Water Resources, River Development & Ganga Rejuvenation

VACANCY NOTICE
EXTENSION OF LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF APPLICATION
The vacancy notice published in the Employment News edition dated 21-27 March 2026 for filling the following four (04) posts in the Mahadayi PRAWAH on a deputation basis (including short-term contract) by this office is hereby revised. The last date for submission of duly filled applications, which was 04.05.2026, has been further extended by 30 days from the date of publication of this vacancy notice in the Employment News.
S. No. Name of the post Pay Scale No. of Posts.
1. Member (Environmental Issues) Level-14 (Rs.144200-218200) 01
2. Member (Hydrology) Level-14 (Rs.144200-218200) 01
3. Member (Monitoring and Regulation) Level-14 (Rs.144200-218200) 01
4. Director (Finance) Level-13 (Rs.123100-215900) 01
2. All other terms and conditions of the previous vacancy notice shall remain unchanged. The interested candidates who have not yet applied may submit their applications as per the procedure mentioned in the detailed vacancy notice available on the official website: jalshakti-dowr.gov.in, and dopt.gov.in.
(Sameer Kumar Munda)
Under Secretary to the Govt. of India
Tel: 011-23716252
Email: use4-mowr@nic.in

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Interest is invited from well established firm of Architects / Architect for design and support for an Office-cum-Commercial Building, conforming to regulations. Prime location in MG Road, Bengaluru with Ground area of 30,000 sq. ft.
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Email: projects.tsfods@gmail.com Website: <http://tfoods.telangana.gov.in>
Ref. No. TF/Projects/AMEP2/1278/2026-27 TENDER NOTIFICATION Date: 07/05/2026
Telangana Foods invites E-Tender for Procurement of Additional Machineries like 01) Belt Conveyors, 02) Full Automatic Packaging Machines, 03) Pneumatic Conveying systems, 04) Elevator (Lift) and 05) Epoxy flooring to GWH Plant for Technical specification go through Tender schedule. Bids Submission Closing Date & Time: 15/05/2026 at 1.00 PM. Note: Full Tender Notification & Tender Schedule with Terms & Conditions, Specifications, etc. can be downloaded from Website: <http://tender.aprocurement.gov.in> from 08/05/2026 at 2.00 PM onwards. Sd/- Managing Director
DIPR R.O. No. : 108-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27, Date: 07-05-2026.

JODHPUR VIDYUT VITARAN NIGAM LIMITED
(MATERIAL MANAGEMENT & CONTRACT WING) NEW POWER HOUSE, INDUSTRIAL AREA, JODHPUR-342003 PHONE: (0291) 2742223, FAX: (0291) 2746539
SHORT TERM E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
Short Term E-Procurement Tender is invited for Hiring of Trolley Mounted Lifter having capacity 1 Ton and 2 Ton for to and fro transportation of Distribution Transformer etc on 24 hours basis under TN-2154 (UBN JVV2672SLOB00050).
Details regarding Notification, Tender cost, Earnest Money, Schedule date of tender opening for aforesaid tenders are available on our website at energy.rajjasthan.gov.in/jdvvn and also at <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>.
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NIB CODE- MHS2627A0450
UBIN NO- MHS2627SLRCOO0603
DIPR/C/7820/2026
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INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) (LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)
MAHATRANS CO. LTD.
SRM e-Tender No. T-2635/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre Tender (RFx No. 6000001513)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below. "Balanced work of Construction 400kV D/C line from LILO on 400kV Waluj-Bhusawal line Circuit-II to 400kV Thaptitanda Substation (Route Length- 22.43km) under Ch. Sambhajinagar Zone."
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website <https://srmnetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from 05.05.2026.
Sd/- Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL

INBRIEF



BIS seizes toys and packs of balloons without ISI mark

A team of officials from the Bureau of Indian Standards, Chennai Branch Office, seized about 3,000 toys and nearly 2,870 packs of balloons without the ISI mark during a raid in the city on Wednesday. A press release said the raids were conducted at three establishments in Sowcarpet – Ambika Stores and Mahaveer Enterprises in Narayana Mudali Street and Shetrapal Impex in Rattan Bazar. The team found the firms storing and selling toys and related products in violation of the Quality Control Orders. The operation was carried out with CI Flower Bazaar Police Station. S.D. Dayanand, Senior Director and Head, BIS Chennai Branch Office, said the ISI mark signified conformity to Indian Standards and protected consumers from substandard products.

Text & Context and Health

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (May 8, Friday), the following articles are available:

- Scope of legal fiction in party mergers [newsth.live/1Vdyd5/legalfiction](#)
- Why are fathers missing in reproductive health interventions in India [newsth.live/fathershealth](#)

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Southern Railway replaces 11 manned level crossings with subways, overbridges

This aims to prevent unauthorised crossing of tracks and improve operational efficiency of trains. The ₹100-crore work includes construction of subways at Wallajah Road, Latteri, and Jolarpettai

TRACK TALES
R. Srikanth
CHENNAI

Southern Railway eliminated 11 manual level crossings in the city and completed works to eliminate 12 others in the outskirts during the financial year 2025-26.

To prevent unauthorised crossing of tracks and improve operational efficiency of trains, Southern Railway replaced the level crossings with subways, road overbridges (ROBs), and road under bridges (RUBs).

A senior official with the Chennai Division of Southern Railway said 11 of them had been converted into safe zones through the construction of seven subways, three ROBs, and one RUB, at a cost of over ₹100 crore.

The Radha Nagar subway at the Chromepet railway station led to the closure of level crossing no.



Easing congestion: The Radha Nagar subway at the Chromepet railway station led to the closure of level crossing no. 27, easing traffic flow from Radha Nagar to GST Road. FILE PHOTO

27, easing traffic flow from Radha Nagar to GST Road. Subways have been constructed at Wallajah Road, Latteri, and Jolarpettai, along with ROBs at Sitheri and Othivakkam yard.

Commuters' demands Meanwhile, the commuters are demanding the construction of a subway

and an RUB at Pattabhiram and Avadi railway stations.

Gopalakrishnan, a resident of Pattabhiram, pointed out the need for a subway at Pattabhiram railway station, as commuters faced difficulties in accessing the ROB that was built to replace level crossing no. 10. They had to climb more than 50 steps to safe-

ly cross from South Bazaar to CTH Road, he said.

Social activist T. Sadagopan also wanted an RUB to be constructed to replace the level crossing no. 8 near Avadi railway station. He said an RUB would ease access to the Nehru Bazaar located to the south of the railway station and Avadi bus terminus to the north.



Protective measure: The advisory suggests distributing cooling supplies, such as wet towels and handheld fans, to residents.

Centre calls for steps to safeguard shelter residents from heat

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

As heatwave conditions intensify, the Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs has issued an advisory to the States and Union Territories to protect vulnerable people staying in shelters under the Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM).

In a communication dated April 30, the Ministry said temperatures had already risen sharply in many regions and were expected to worsen in the coming weeks.

The advisory was addressed to the Mission Directors of the DAY-NULM in States and Union Territories implementing the Shelter for Urban Homeless component.

The Ministry directed urban local bodies (ULBs) and shelter management agencies (SMAs) to take immediate steps to ensure the safety and well-being of shelter residents during extreme heat conditions.

The advisory called for adequate and regular supply of potable drinking water, clean water for bathing, and oral rehydration solution packets and salted drinks. Authorities were told to ensure that the shelters had functional fans, water dispensers, and other cooling facilities.

The advisory also suggested setting up water

points, with access to cold water, for residents. To reduce health risks during summer, the Ministry directed local bodies to undertake fogging and sanitation measures to control mosquitoes and prevent vector-borne diseases.

The advisory stressed the need for prompt maintenance of ventilation systems, fans, drinking water supply, and other cooling systems to improve airflow. It also asked shelter authorities to conduct regular awareness sessions on heat safety, symptoms of heat-related illnesses, and hydration practices. It suggested distributing cooling supplies, such as wet towels and handheld fans, to residents.

As part of emergency preparedness measures, ULBs and SMAs were asked to form city-level rescue teams equipped with adequate personnel and vehicles. Helplines should also be activated to receive distress calls, the advisory said. The Ministry further directed that all shelters be geo-tagged, with their coordinates being displayed on various portals, to improve accessibility during emergencies.

The advisory called for training shelter staff to identify signs of heat-related illnesses and implement response protocols. They should be designated to monitor shelter conditions and enforce heatwave procedures, it said.

Sanitation workers struggle amid soaring temperature

R. Aishwaryaa
CHENNAI

While political negotiations and alliance talks continue in air-conditioned rooms, sanitation workers employed by the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) work on the streets amid soaring temperatures.

The concerns raised by the workers are not new. They had highlighted issues related to drinking water access, toilet facili-

ties, food quality, and heat exposure and submitted several petitions to the GCC in the last two years, but in vain.

Perumal, 50, a sanitation worker with Urbaser Sumeet, a private company to which the GCC outsourced solid waste management, said: "At the waste collection and transfer yard in Kotturpuram, a dining hall was recently set up. It is shaded, so we no longer have to sit on dusty roads. There are

no air-conditioned seating facilities such as the one set up in Saidapet for gig workers," he said.

"The GCC provides us with pongal and rice, but the quantity is not sufficient and lately, the quality too has worsened, so I carry food from home. Water is supplied through tanker lorries, but the containers appear rusted. Sometimes, while on duty, residents offer us tea or buttermilk, which gives us temporary relief. The GCC's plan to

distribute buttermilk for us has not yet begun," he said.

However, S. Lakshmi, a National Urban Livelihood Mission (NULM) staff sanitation worker in Ambattur zone, said buttermilk distribution had begun there. "The main issue is that many workers get exhausted because of the heat. Officials ask those who feel unwell to return home, and tell the rest of us to complete their work," she said.

She also alleged that water supply remained in-

adequate. "Only a few water cans are kept at the zonal office. They are insufficient for the nearly 200 workers in this area," she added.

Thirumaleshwari, a sanitation worker in Royapuram zone, said that on Wednesday, her blood pressure increased due to prolonged exposure to the sun.

"This has been an issue for over five years. No matter what the weather is, we have to continue working.

There is no other option," she said.

Uncomfortable uniforms were another major concern. Mr. Perumal said the fabric of their uniforms blocked airflow. "The rubber gloves also make our palms sweat excessively, making it difficult to work," he added.

K. Bharathi of the Left Trade Union Centre and the Uzhaippor Urimai Iyakam said the uniforms had been designed without consulting workers.

Man swaps ATM card, dupes senior citizen of ₹42,000 in Perambur

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 69-year-old man was duped of ₹42,000 after a stranger allegedly swapped his ATM card for a dummy card at a kiosk in Perambur on Wednesday morning.

The incident took place when the victim, Rajendran, a retired CMDA employee of Perambur, visited an ATM on Paper Mills Road to withdraw cash. According to the police, an unidentified man inside the kiosk offered him assistance to operate the machine.

The suspect allegedly said the transaction had failed and returned the

ATM card to Rajendran before leaving the premises. Rajendran returned home unaware that the suspect had taken his original card.

A few minutes later, he received mobile phone alerts indicating that ₹42,000 had been withdrawn from his bank account through four separate transactions.

On verifying the card, he discovered that it was fake and that his card had been stolen.

Based on a complaint lodged by Rajendran, the Sembium police registered a case and launched an investigation. The police are examining the CCTV footage of the ATM centre to trace the suspect.

Timings			
CHENNAI			
FRIDAY, MAY. 08			
RISE	05:46	SET	18:26
RISE	23:59	SET	10:48
SATURDAY, MAY. 09			
RISE	05:46	SET	18:26
RISE	00:00	SET	11:40
SUNDAY, MAY. 10			
RISE	05:46	SET	18:26
RISE	00:40	SET	12:31

Chennai Weather			
Tiruvallur	max	min	
	40	27	
Chennai Airport	39	30	
Chennai City	36	30	

Chennai Airport Today 37°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night also will be comfortable. Dry weather is likely.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow 38°C The weather will be dry. Day will be slightly hot and uneasy. Night will be comfortable.

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THE HINDU
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Tamil Nadu

Objective of NDPS Act can be achieved only by carrying out structural reforms, says HC

Justice B. Pugalendhi says the investigation in cases under the NDPS Act should mandatorily include financial investigation into the proceeds of crime and the forfeiture of illegal properties

B. Tilak Chandar
MADURAI

Unless structural reforms are introduced in investigation, data integration, inter-agency coordination, and institutional capacity, the objective of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act cannot be effectively achieved, the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has said while issuing suggestions in this regard to authorities.

The court said a substantial number of cases originated from Madurai, Theni, and Dindigul districts. Approximately over 50% of the cases reported in Tamil Nadu were from these districts. Justice B. Pugalendhi said the investigation in cases under the NDPS Act should mandatorily include financial investigation into the proceeds of crime and the forfeiture of illegal properties under Chapter V-A of the NDPS Act and should not be confined merely to seizure and arrest.

The court said financial investigation should extend to both commercial



Dedicated manpower should be provided for intelligence processing and tracking the online networks of drug traffickers, the court said.

and intermediate quantities of narcotic and psychotropic substances. The authorities should, in appropriate cases, initiate proceedings under Chapter V-A of the NDPS Act for identification, attachment, and forfeiture of the illegally acquired properties.

The Director General of Police should issue comprehensive standing instructions mandating financial profiling of accused persons, systematic asset tracing, and effective coordination with banks and financial institutions, the court said.

The State should strengthen specialised agencies such as NIB-CID by filling vacancies on priority, aug-

menting sanctioned strength commensurate with workload, and ensuring that adequately equipped and functional units are established across the districts and major urban centres. Dedicated manpower should be provided for intelligence processing and tracking the online networks of drug traffickers, the court said.

The court said a structured coordination mechanism should be developed with Village Administrative Officers in Madurai, Theni and Dindigul districts in respect of accused persons hailing from these districts but residing in Andhra Pradesh,

Telangana, and Odisha. A comprehensive database should be created, and their movements should be kept under continuous watch.

A dedicated dashboard for the NIB-CID reflecting the number of cases registered and status of investigations should be designed by the State Crime Records Bureau. A separate platform should be created within the CCTNS platform to enable real-time access to case data, accused details, and investigation status of NDPS cases, the court said.

The court said every case registered should be automatically and contemporaneously reflected in the CCTNS system and brought to the notice of the NIB-CID unit, so as to ensure coordinated monitoring, intelligence sharing, and appropriate intervention.

The court said law enforcement agencies in the State should strengthen inter-State coordination with law enforcement agencies of neighbouring and source States through structured intelligence-sharing mechanisms.

New plant species discovered in southern Eastern Ghats, named after Annamalai varsity founder

Deepa H. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Two botany students from Annamalai University in Chidambaram and their guide have discovered a new plant species in the grape family. Found in the southern Eastern Ghats of Tamil Nadu, in Villupuram district, during a climb up the 290-foot-tall Sanjeevi hill for documenting plants, the species has been named *Cyphostemma annamalaii* after the founder of the university, Rajah Sir Annamalai Chettiyar.



The species named after Annamalai Chettiyar.

Phytochemical analysis “It has a different morphology from others in allied species. For instance, *Cyphostemma setosum*, an allied species, starts with a single leaf and ends with three leaves, and has an ovate-shaped fruit that is red. The petals are greenish-white on the top half, then becoming reddish brown. It also has medicinal properties and is used to treat stomach ulcers, and is antidiabetic and antimicrobial. Whereas *Cyphostemma annamalaii* is a climber with a round fruit that is yellow. The petals of the flowers are white or yellow. It starts with three leaves and ends with three leaves. The phytochemical analysis of the plant is nearing complete,” explained S. Akash, who, along with another PhD scholar, K. Manikandan, found the climber with its distinct leaves and fruit. They are presently pursuing their PhDs under A. Rajesh of the Department of Medicinal Botany, Siddha Medical College, Palayamkottai.

L. Mullainathan, a professor and HOD of Botany at Annamalai University, explained that the family *Vitaceae Juss.*, commonly known as the grape family, comprises over 1,000 species belonging to 20 genera, of which *Cyphostemma* is the second largest genus, consisting of nearly 250 species. It is found in tropical and subtropical regions. “The students found the plant at an elevation of 86m in that tropical dry forest in Panaimalaipettai,” he added.

Mr. Manikandan said that the plant was growing

in open, scrubby vegetation. It had a tuberous root and climbed by utilising surrounding vegetation for support.

287 species “Over a period of one year, we documented 287 species found on the hill. Locals use a lot of these plants. Some are used for fodder and others for medicinal purposes. They also collect wood for fuel and honey from the tall trees inside the dense forest area. It is also a sacred grove and has two temples – one attributed to Perumal, which is located inside a cave, and another, a Shivan temple. We saw animals including snakes such as the king cobra, porcupines, garden lizards, butterflies, and eagles. There are no steps leading to the temples,” he added.

Mr. Rajesh explained that the species was officially published in the journal *Phytotaxa* in March 2026. “The herbarium with the dried plants has been submitted to St. Joseph’s College in Tiruchi and to the Botanical Survey of India in Coimbatore. This find has been reviewed by experts in Vitaceae, which means *Cyphostemma annamalaii* is indeed a new species. Even locals do not have a name for it.”

Rangasamy resigns as CM; set for a new term

The Hindu Bureau
PUDUCHERRY

Four days after the National Democratic Alliance retained power for the second consecutive term in Puducherry, Chief Minister N. Rangasamy, on Thursday, tendered his resignation to Lieutenant Governor K. Kailashnathan at Lok Niwas in Puducherry.

He met Mr. Kailashnathan around noon to handover his resignation letter for the Lt. Governor to proceed with the next government formation.

Shortly after submitting the resignation, Mr. Rangasamy told media persons outside Lok Niwas that the letter stating claim to form the next government will be submitted to the Lt. Governor very soon. In the 2026 Assembly elections, the NDA had won 18 out of the 30 seats.

While Chief Minister’s All India N.R. Congress (AINRC) has won 12 seats, the other constituents of NDA – the Bharatiya Janata Party secured four, the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) and the Latchiya Jananayaga Katchi (LJK) have won one seat each in the 30 member Legislative Assembly in the Union Territory.

CORRIGENDUM-05 FOR TENDER
NOTICE NO.: CON/2026/FEB/03
DATED: 28-02-2026

Corrigendum No. 05 for Tender Notice No. CON/2026/FEB/03, dated: 28-02-2026 against Tender No. CE-CONFT-EPC-2026-04 has been published. For details please visit in website www.ireps.gov.in.

CE/Con/LMG Project, Maligaon
NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY
Construction Organization
Serving Customers With A Smile

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Tender No.- टीएआरडी/सीए/ई.टी./26-27/1

1. Name of work with its location: Provision of portals at VPDA yard and MOG Yard in place of TTC in the jurisdiction of SSP depot, 2. Approx. cost of the works: Rs 1,85,03,422/- 3. Earnest Money to be deposited: Rs 3,70,100/- 4. Date & time for submission of e-tender and opening of e-tender: Opening of e-tenders on 29.05.2026 at 12.00 Hrs. in the office of the Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer (TRD), DRM Office, E.C. Railway, Sonpur. 5. Website particulars and notice board location where complete details of e-tender can be seen: Website: <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

Notice Board: DRM Office Campus, E. C. Railway, Sonpur.
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRD
East Central Railway/Sonpur
PR/0184/SEE/TRD/T/26-27/28

INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY, CHENNAI-38
EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY (ICF), CHENNAI, a leading manufacturer of passenger coaches, MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA invites.

Expressions of interest from organizations for **Design, Manufacture, Supply, Installation and Proving out of Fixtures and Tools required for the manufacture of Railway coaches.** Firms having design capability alone, manufacturing capability alone or both design manufacturing capability are invited to respond.

Organizations willing to participate may furnish their Expression of Interest (EOI) for taking up the above work, giving their company profile with details of their CAD infrastructure, Design expertise and customer base and send on or before 25.05.2026 to-

CHIEF DESIGN ENGINEER / MECHANICAL
INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY, CHENNAI - 600 038.
Phone / Fax No. 044-26261872
E-mail : cdemicf@gmail.com

For details please refer to website <https://icf.indianrailways.gov.in/>- Tender Information - Expression of Interest

AME/Design

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR
No.: NIT/2026-27/577-58 Date: 06/05/2026

निविदा सूचना/2026-27

निविदाकर्ता को निविदा के लिए केन्द्र, राज्य सरकार के अधिनियमित विभागों एवं उनके अधीनस्थ संस्थानों में सूचीकृत एवं अनुसूची सेवेदार के निर्धारित प्रारम्भ में ई-ऑनलाइन निविदा प्रणाली पर ऑनलाइन निविदा अर्पित करनी होगी :-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत (रु.)	निविदा सूचना संख्या
Renewal / Strengthening of Road at Various Places in Rajasthan.		
UBN: (1) RRC2627WLOB00085 (2) RRC2627WLOB00087 (3) RRC2627WLOB00090	8557.36 Lakh	ई-058/26-27
UBN: (1) RRC2627WLOB00093 (2) RRC2627WLOB00091 (3) RRC2627WLOB00086	10429.15 Lakh	ई-059/26-27
UBN: (1) RRC2627WLOB00094 (2) RRC2627WLOB00095 (3) RRC2627WLOB00097	18471.27 Lakh	अल्पकालीन ई-060/26-27
UBN: (1) RRC2627WLOB00098 (2) RRC2627WLOB00098 (3) RRC2627WLOB00092 (4) RRC2627WLOB00081	4581.42 Lakh	ई-061/26-27
UBN: (1) RRC2627WLOB00104	1854.50 Lakh	ई-064/26-27

निविदा के सम्बन्धित प्रारम्भ में निविदा प्रकृत, सूचीकृत राशि, अनुसूचित करने से सूची की सीमा वरिष्ठ सामग्री विवरण एवं सूचीकृत वेबसाइट: <http://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in> <http://pppp.raajasthan.nic.in> <http://pww.raajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc> पर देखा जा सकता है। दृष्टिकर सेवेदार को अपने निविदा प्रकृत के माध्यम से वेबसाइट <http://eproc.raajasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।

महाराष्ट्र

THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Dy. Chief Engineer (CON), South Eastern Railway, Rourkela invites E-tender for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website www.ireps.gov.in. The tender will be closed at 12.00 hrs. on due date. **E-Tender Notice No.: 371614-ROU-DCE-C-01-2026, Date: 06.05.2026, Brief Description of work:** Execution of Earthwork in formation by filling and cutting, blanketing, slide, drain, central drain, catch water drain, protection work, P. way track linking work, P.Way fitting, transportation of P. Way materials, supply of ballast, construction of service buildings, construction of FOB & metalizing work etc. of Keochahal Vard modification in connection with GCT to serve M's NTPC, Darlipal STPP (Deposit terms) under the jurisdiction of Dy. Chief Engineer/Con/ Rourkela of South Eastern Railway. **Approx. Cost:** ₹ 14.84 Crore. **Bid Security:** ₹ 29,70,000. **Completion Period:** 12 months. **Closing Date:** 01.06.2026. Interested tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details/ description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this item will be accepted. **N.B.:** Prospective bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all other tenders. (PR-137)

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Tiruchirappalli Division
Tender No. 95265294A, Due Date: 27.05.2026

The following E-tender has been published in IREPS website. Firms are requested to login to <https://www.ireps.gov.in> -> Login -> E-tender -> Goods & services (new) and quote against the tender. Manual quotations will not be entertained.

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Description	Due Date
1.	95265294A	Fire Extinguisher with anti-theft alarm as per Specification No. MDTs 46270 Rev-6 with base document IS 15683/2018 and as per DRG CC64262 ALT-4. Details are available in tender schedule.	27.05.2026

Senior Divisional Materials Manager / Tiruchirappalli
For and on behalf of the President of India

ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, BHOPAL
(An Autonomous Institute under MoH&FW, Government of India)
Saket Nagar, Bhopal (M.P.)-462020, www.aiimsbhopal.edu.in

Advt. No.: ADM-2(4)/Rect.cell/Contract/GY/2026/3142 Dated: 06/05/2026

INTERVIEW FOR ENGAGEMENT OF GYNACEOLOGY CONSULTANT (IVF) & EMBRYOLOGIST AT AIIMS BHOPAL PURELY ON CONTRACTUAL BASIS

All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), Bhopal will hold an Interview for engagement of 01 Gynecology Consultant (IVF) & 01 Embryologist on purely contractual basis with consolidated monthly remuneration.

For details of essential eligibility criteria, terms & conditions of engagement, application form, application procedure and the date (s) of document verification & Interview, the detailed advertisement may be referred on the Institute's website - www.aiimsbhopal.edu.in. Candidates fulfilling the eligibility criteria and aspiring to attend the interview may submit their application in the prescribed format within 10 days of the publication of this advertisement on recruitment.contractual@aiimsbhopal.edu.in. The date of interview and document verification shall be notified separately on Institute's website only.

Sd/-
Dy. Director (Admin), AIIMS, Bhopal

KOCHI METRO RAIL LIMITED
(A joint venture company of Govt. of India & Govt. of Kerala)
4th Floor, JLN Stadium Metro Station, Kaloor, Ernakulam-682017
Ph: 0484-2846700

E-TENDER

E-Tender cum Auction Notice for Property Development and Lease of part of building at Edapally Metro Station

Tender ID 2026_KMRL_848855_1
Bid submission and date : 16.05.2026

Tender documents can be downloaded from www.etenders.kerala.gov.in/ or www.kochimetro.org
Further corrigendum & addendum will be published only on website

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
INSTITUTE FOR DESIGN OF ELECTRICAL MEASURING INSTRUMENTS, MUMBAI
वैद्युतिक मापन उपकरण अधिकारण संस्थान, मुंबई

Government Certificate Course on Artificial Intelligence R & D

Course Timing- 07.30 PM to 8.30 PM (ONLINE) Date- 20 to 27 May 2026
Venue : IDEMI, Swatantraaveer Tatya Tope Marg, Churnabhatti, Sion PO Mumbai - 400 022
Email ID : training@idemi.org Website: www.idemi.org
Fundamentals of AI in Pharmaceutical Sciences, Applications of AI in Drug Discovery & Pharma Industry, AI Tools for Research & Scientific Writing, Ethical Use of AI in Research, Future Impact & Challenges of AI in Healthcare, Top 30 tools for education, Research Excellence and productivity enhancement, Basic of Molecular modelling, Structure Based Drug Design, Homology Modelling Molecular Docking, Molecular Dynamic Simulation.

Fees 4000/- 18% GST (Fees are non refundable)
After successful completion certificate will be issued.

एडमिशन फी / कॉल फी between 10 am to 6 pm
Contact: 9403566219, 8007765693, 9869087617

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
Chennai Division
E-Auction Notice / Catering / Passenger Amenities / E-Auction / 2026

The Divisional Railway Manager, Chennai Division, Southern Railway, calls for bids (commercial) through E-Auction and E-tender for award of Catering staff contracts and Passenger Amenities contracts in the following Railway Stations / Locations. The E-auctions scheduled are as detailed below:-

Sl. No.	Catalogue No	Subcategory	Location/ Site	Auction Date	Tendering Mode	Auction Time
1	MAS-PAUT-425	Pay and Use Toilet	VDR	07.05.2026	E-auction	15:00
2	MAS-PAUT-425	Pay and Use Toilet	PZA	07.05.2026	E-auction	15:00
3	MAS-PAUT-425	Pay and Use Toilet	UPM	07.05.2026	E-auction	15:00
4	MAS-PBCO-26-06	Premium Brand Catering Outlet	CGL	13.05.2026	E-auction	15:00
5	MAS-WVM-2026-05	Water Vending Machine	CGL	14.05.2026	E-auction	15:00

All other details can be viewed on the website - www.ireps.gov.in
Senior Divisional Commercial Manager / Chennai

SOUTHERN RAILWAY
SALEM DIVISION
E-TENDER NOTICE No. SA-E2-2026-27-W1-W2, Dated: 04.05.2026

Divisional Railway Manager / Electrical / Salem Division, Salem - 5 for and on behalf of the President of India invites E-Tender for the under mentioned works. Online bids only will be accepted. For detailed NIT, qualification criteria, bidding document, tender submission etc., can be viewed / downloaded from website portal www.ireps.gov.in

E-Tender Notice No, Date and Name of Work	Details
1) SA-E2-2026-27-W1 Dated: 04.05.2026 Comprehensive Annual Maintenance contract (CAMC) for Johnson make Escalators and lifts available at Salem Division for a period of 5 years.	Approx. Cost - ₹ 79,48,166.00/- EMD - ₹ 1,59,000.00/- Tender Booklet cost : ₹ 5900/- Completion Period - 60 Months
2) SA-E2-2026-27-W2 Dated: 04.05.2026 Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) for Air Conditioners and Water Coolers over Salem Division for a period of two years.	Approx. Cost - ₹ 54,01,272.00/- EMD - ₹ 1,08,000.00/- Tender Booklet cost : ₹ 5900/- Completion Period - 24 Months

For all the works Closing Time & Date 15.00 hrs. on 04.06.2026
For all the works Bids Opening Time & Date 15.30 hrs. on 04.06.2026

All Addendum / Corrigendum, Time extension, Clarifications, etc. will be uploaded in the website portal www.ireps.gov.in only and will not be published separately in Newspapers. Bidders should regularly visit website to keep themselves updated.

Divisional Railway Manager (Electrical) / Salem

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Hastakalaa
CRAFTS | TEXTILES | HOME DECOR | JEWELLERY

Craftsmen from across India featuring Innovative Designs
Handcrafted Decors, Organic Products & Engaging Daily Workshops

Date: 08th to 17th May 2026
Timings: 11.00 am. to 9.00 pm.

Venue:
CERC CAMPUS EXHIBITION GROUND
Kalakshetra Road, Opp. Pamban Swamy Koil
Thiruvannmiyur, Chennai - 600 041.

Pet Adoption Drive on 08th, 09th, 10th May & 16th, 17th May
From 4.00 pm to 7.00 pm

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Rail Wheel Plant/Bela
(Distt. - Saran), Bihar 841221

E Tender No.:- RWP-PLG-OT-2026-1
"Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer/PLG/ Rail Wheel Plant, Bela for and on behalf of President of India invites online "e-Open Tender" through Indian Railways E-Procurement Portal (IREPS) www.ireps.gov.in for following work. 1. Name of work with its location and completion period: Design, Engineering, Supply, Installation, Erection, Commissioning, Testing of Cold Air Ventilation System for operators at different locations in Mould room at RWP/Bela and CAMC for this system for 05 years Post Warranty. 2. Approx. cost of the work: Rs. - 2815302.00/- 3. Earnest Money to be Deposited : Rs. 578300.00/- 4. Cost of tender document : Nil, 5. Pre-Bid Conference Date Time : 13/05/2026 at 12:00 Hrs. 6. Tender closing date and time : 05/06/2026, 15.00 hrs. 7. Website particulars, Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc. : E Tender No. RWP-PLG-OT-2026-1, For full details and submission of bid kindly visit Portal (IREPS) www.ireps.gov.in. The prospective firms/ bidders submitting bid are advised to remain in touch with IREPS Portal (www.ireps.gov.in) for updates including Addendum/Corrigendum/ Cancellation with respect to the above tender because no such any notice/ information concerned that shall be published in newspaper. Dy. CME/PLG, Rail Wheel Plant/Bela RWP/CPRO/Adv/2026-27/14

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SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY
Corrigendum to Tender Notice No. CAO/C/NBC/172/2026 Dated : 27-02-2026

Name of the Work	Approx. Value
RFP for Construction of New Broad Gauge Line between Chainage 90000 and Chainage 130375 (40.375 km) including Civil & Track works, Signal & Telecommunication works, Railway Electrification and Electrical General Services between Hiriyr (IHYR) (Incl.) & Palavanahalli (PLVHL) (Incl.) stations and Extension of various bridges (Civil works) between Palavanahalli (PLVHL) (Excl.) & Chitradurga (CTA) (Excl) stations (Chainage 130375 to Chainage 140490 (10.115 km)) in Tumakuru-Chitradurga Davangere New Line Project on EPC Mode. (Tender Ref. No. TK-DVG-EPC-05)	Rs. 7,82,76,56,049/-

Date of Closing

Existing	Modified
13-05-2026 (15:00 Hrs.)	26-05-2026 (15:00 Hrs.)

For details log on: www.ireps.gov.in

Deputy Chief Engineer / Construction / Works
Bangaluru Cantonment
PUB/99/AAS/PRB/SWR/2026-27

Download the RailOne app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

Open Tender through E-Tendering 2026-27
NIT No: LWS-TC-OPN-EC1600HP-2026
Date-06.05.2026, For and on behalf of The President of India, Dy. CME/Loco Ajmer invites e-tender with following:-
S.N. 1, Name of work: Work of Engine major schedule overhauling/repair of 1600 HP DEMU DPC, Model QSK50L, Make-CIL, Quantity- 06 Nos. at Loco Workshop, N.W. Railway, Ajmer for 01 year, 2 Estimated Cost of work: Rs. 15,21,75,461/-, 3 Address of the NIT issuing office: Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer (Loco) Diesel Loco & Wagon Workshop Lal Phatak, Ajmer (Raj.)- 335001, 4 Earnest money to be deposited: Rs.3043500/- (Only through net banking or payment gateway on IREPS portal), 5 Last Date and time for submission and opening of E-tender: 29.05.2026 up to 15.00 E-tender will be opened at 15.30 on same day. Due to indispensable reasons bid opening schedule may change. 6 Website particular where complete details of e-tender can be seen and participated: www.ireps.gov.in, (Note- This is E-tender so tenderer can participate through e-tendering process only on mentioned website within bidding period) details, interested firms/tenderer may participate through IREPS portal in this e-tender. 669-DO/26

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CM
YK

Pinarayi promises to listen to people, make corrections

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Breaking his silence after the Left Democratic Front (LDF) suffered a debilitating blow in the Assembly elections, Communist Party of India (Marxist) Polit Bureau member Pinarayi Vijayan wrote on social media on Thursday that the “unexpected” verdict marked a new beginning for the Left’s continued political work, not an end.

The alliance, he said, was committed to restoring the people’s faith in it and marching ahead with renewed vigour. Constant vigil was needed to ensure that the development projects and welfare schemes implemented in the past 10 years, which had brought sweeping changes in society, did not halt and were taken forward.

The Left, he said, would make no bones about an open examination of the election results and would listen seriously to criticisms and concerns raised by the public, Left supporters and members, and act upon them.

Reasons for defeat

He attributed the results to an environment created by forces that opposed the Left, such as the UDF, the BJP and a section of the media, besides “false campaigns unleashed by certain anarchic and apolitical centres” which gave some people some misgivings. Serious efforts would be made to sensitise them to the facts, he said.

The Left, he added,



Pinarayi Vijayan

would not be set back by lies and PR-driven false campaigns.

However, it would democratically examine the lapses in its own policies and interventions and carry out necessary corrections before marching ahead with greater confidence and clarity.

As the Opposition, he said, the front would ensure that the Left’s vision for a *Nava Keralam* – conceived through a knowledge economy, employment for youth, social justice, public health and education – was taken forward. The new government would be pressured into implementing the policies initiated by the LDF for poverty eradication and women empowerment.

The Left would be a responsible Opposition, supporting the new government’s actions to better the standard of living of the people while opposing its anti-people policies, he added.

He thanked the voters who reposed their faith in the Left and congratulated the UDF on its win.

Kerala Congress drives hard bargain after electoral revival

Party has staked claim for two ministerial berths and the post of Chief Whip in the incoming UDF Cabinet; leaders cite party’s strong base among Christian community, Church’s support for alliance

The Hindu Bureau
KOTTAYAM

Riding high on its 2026 election performance, the Kerala Congress under P.J. Joseph has entered the post-poll negotiation table with firm demands for Cabinet representation. The party has staked claim for two ministerial berths and the post of Chief Whip in the incoming United Democratic Front Cabinet.

After nearly a decade on the margins of power since 2016, the Kerala Congress has staged a decisive return, contesting eight seats and securing seven in Kerala. Meeting at the party



The Kerala Congress, under chairperson P.J. Joseph, centre, said it deserves ‘fair representation’ in the Cabinet. FILE PHOTO

chairman’s residence in Thodupuzha, the newly elected legislators decided that the party would press for two key ministerial portfolios.

“As the third largest partner in the front, we are entitled to two ministerial

posts. We have seven members in the House and a strong mandate. Naturally, we deserve fair representation in the Cabinet,” said Apu John Joseph, who won from Thodupuzha. Senior leader Mons Joseph was elected parliamentary par-

ty leader in the Assembly.

With the Indian Union Muslim League expected to secure five ministerial berths, Kerala Congress leaders insist that their party, with its strong base among the Christian community, was entitled to at least two. “If the League gets five posts, the Kerala Congress should get two. We represent a significant section of the Christian community, and the Church extended strong support to the UDF in this election,” a senior leader noted. In the previous UDF Ministry as well, the Kerala Congress had held two ministerial posts along with the Chief Whip position.

KC(M) faces turmoil ahead of steering committee meet

The Hindu Bureau
KOTTAYAM

The post-poll phase of Kerala Congress(M) in Kerala, following an electoral rout, appears to be moving quickly from reflection to rupture, with internal dissent and electoral disappointment setting the tone for a meeting of the party steering committee on Saturday.

The crisis has deepened after the regional party failed to win even a single

seat out of the 12 it contested under the Left Democratic Front (LDF) banner.

The contrast with the Kerala Congress faction led by P.J. Joseph, which secured seven seats, has only left the party red-faced. A growing section of leaders is admitting that the results have inflicted serious damage on cadre morale, while also triggering a wider debate on the party’s political identity. Many argue the KC(M) has steadily diluted its independent space after

aligning with the LDF and that a crucial opportunity to reconsider its alignment ahead of the polls, reportedly at the instance of Roshy Augustine, was lost.

It is in this charged atmosphere that the intervention of State committee member Jayakrishnan Puthiyedath has acquired significance. Mr. Puthiyedath, who accused Roshy Augustine of blocking a potential shift back to the UDF, was expelled from the party.

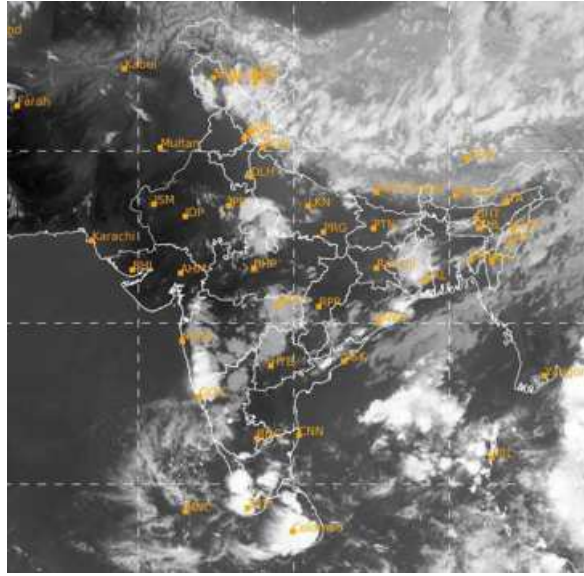
Police case against two IUML workers

The Hindu Bureau
MALAPPURAM

The police have registered a case against two Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) workers for publicly displaying a severed goat’s head during victory celebrations following the defeat of Left Democratic Front (LDF) candidate and former Minister K.T. Jaleel at Thavanur in Malappuram district of Kerala. The act, widely shared on social media, drew criticism.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 17.45 HRS)

Forecast for Friday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Lakshadweep and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	30.....	32.4.....	22.0.....	Kozhikode	38.....	33.8.....	25.2.....
Ahmedabad		43.2.....	27.8.....	Kurnool		40.5.....	28.2.....
Aizawl	9.8.....	28.7.....	17.4.....	Lucknow	12.....	29.5.....	18.0.....
Allahabad		32.6.....	22.2.....	Madurai		34.5.....	24.6.....
Bengaluru		32.5.....	22.5.....	Mangaluru		30.6.....	26.6.....
Bhopal		39.0.....	23.2.....	Mumbai		34.4.....	26.7.....
Bhubaneswar		36.7.....	26.4.....	Mysuru		34.2.....	21.8.....
Chandigarh		30.2.....	22.0.....	New Delhi		33.6.....	23.8.....
Chennai		37.1.....	28.5.....	Patna	19.....	32.6.....	19.6.....
Coimbatore	5.....	33.4.....	22.6.....	Port Blair	0.2.....	32.5.....	26.8.....
Dehradun		29.3.....	18.2.....	Puducherry		34.2.....	27.2.....
Gangtok	3.....	17.2.....	13.1.....	Pune		40.2.....	26.0.....
Goa		36.2.....	26.5.....	Raipur		39.2.....	24.4.....
Guwahati	2.....	32.8.....	21.0.....	Ranchi	4.....	32.6.....	19.0.....
Hubballi		35.0.....	23.0.....	Shillong	6.....	22.0.....	12.5.....
Hyderabad		36.8.....	26.3.....	Shimla	1.....	24.5.....	14.2.....
Imphal		29.5.....	19.8.....	Srinagar		27.9.....	11.0.....
Jaipur		40.4.....	26.1.....	Thiruvananthapuram	8.....	34.1.....	25.0.....
Kochi	7.....	31.4.....	25.0.....	Tiruchi		36.8.....	26.6.....
Kohima		22.0.....	13.0.....	Vijayawada		36.4.....	27.4.....
Kolkata	18.....	32.2.....	23.2.....	Visakhapatnam		35.1.....	27.1.....

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	.82	.68	.3	140	188		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Sri
Bengaluru	.16	.19	.50	42	106		Ganganagar, Rajasthan
Chennai	.17	.10	.16	31	40		recorded an overall air
Delhi	.36	.8	.48	195	156		quality index (AQI) score
Hyderabad	.16	.14	.35	66	89		of 301 indicating an
Kolkata	.13	.27	.34	74	63		unhealthy level of
Lucknow	.12	.9	.39	108	117		pollution. In contrast,
Mumbai	.2	.9	.68	73	112		Naharlagun, Arunachal
Pune		.30	123	64	106		Pradesh recorded a
Visakhapatnam	.9	.47	.11	35	86		healthy AQI score of 24

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Urban clean-up



Restoring glory: Desilting work is under way at Ulsoor Lake in Bengaluru on Thursday, as part of a ₹107-crore rejuvenation project for the 106-acre water body, one of the few in central Bengaluru. SUDHAKARA JAIN

BJP cadre ransack BRS MLA’s camp office over ‘derogatory remarks’

The Hindu Bureau
KARIMNAGAR

Tension erupted in Karimnagar town in Telangana after BJP cadre vandalised the camp office of Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) MLA Gangula Kamalakar, and made a vain bid to attack BRS MLA from Huzurabad P. Kaushik Reddy in the town on Thursday.

The furious BJP cadre, armed with sticks, stormed the camp office to protest against what they termed as “unwarranted and derogatory remarks” by Mr. Reddy against Union Minister of State for Home Affairs Bandi Sajay during a press conference held at the camp office earlier in the day.

Mr. Reddy had accused



BRS leaders filing a police complaint over the attack by BJP cadre in Karimnagar on Thursday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Mr. Sanjay of using tobacco mixed with drugs and dared him to undergo a drug test. The remarks triggered a violent protest by the BJP workers, who went berserk, ransacking the office furniture and smashing the window panes of

Mr. Reddy’s car.

The angry BJP cadre also attempted to attack Mr. Reddy, who was inside the conference hall of the camp office, where he addressed a press conference earlier in the day.

Even as the police

locked the main entrance gate of the camp office, the protesters tried to scale the gate. As tension mounted, the police dispersed the agitators by resorting to mild lathicharge.

A video of the incident went viral on social media, triggering a war of words between the leaders of the BRS and the BJP over the issue. The local BRS leaders filed a police complaint against several BJP workers, including two municipal corporators, seeking stringent action against them for allegedly vandalising the Karimnagar MLA’s office.

Meanwhile, the BRS town committee has called a Karimnagar bandh on May 9 in protest against the “violent mob attack”.

Entertaining petitions on religious practices can have far-reaching consequences, says SC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday said a deluge of petitions complaining about religious practices and religion would follow if the courts start interfering in matters of faith.

“If everybody starts questioning religious practices or matters of religion before a constitutional court, then what will happen to this civilisation where religion is so intimately connected with the Indian society. There will be hundreds of petitions questioning this right, that right, opening of temple, closure of the temple,” Jus-

tice B.V. Nagarathna observed during a nine-judge Bench hearing of the Sabarimala review case.

Justice Nagarathna said India’s uniqueness lay in the fact that it was a “civilisation” in which the intimate relationship between people and religion has been a constant, despite pluralities and diversities.

‘Can’t break ties’

The judge asked whether the courts were the right forum to question, examine and intervene in this relationship. “We nine judges, what we lay down is for a civilisation, that is India. India must progress. Despite all its develop-



Justice Nagarathna asked whether courts were the right forum to intervene in the relationship between people and religion.

ment, economy, everything, there is a constant in us, we cannot break that constant. That is what is troubling us,” Justice Nagarathna said.

Justice M.M. Sundresh, on the Bench headed by

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, said entertaining petitions challenging religious practices and beliefs for violation of fundamental rights may open the flood gates with far-reaching consequences.

“Every religion will break, every constitutional court will have to be closed,” the judge remarked.

‘Governed by law’

Senior advocate Raju Ramachandran, for petitioners challenging the practice of excommunication in the Dawoodi Bohra community, pointed out that India was indeed a civilisation, but a civilisation governed by a Constitution.

“Therefore, nothing that goes against the grain of our Constitution can be countenanced in a civilised society governed by the Constitution,” Mr. Ramachandran said.

A.P. has regained confidence of investors, witnessing one MoU a day: CM to Collectors

G.V.R. Subba Rao
VIJAYAWADA

Projecting Andhra Pradesh as a State on the rebound after years of “financial ruin and administrative collapse”, Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu on Thursday called for faster, innovation-led governance to position the State as a “national benchmark” in development, investments and service delivery.

Addressing Collectors and senior officials at the 7th Collectors’ Conference at the Secretariat, he delivered a strong political and administrative message,



N. Chandrababu Naidu at the 7th Collectors’ Conference.

asserting that his government had pulled Andhra Pradesh out of an unprecedented crisis inherited from the previous regime. Highlighting the State’s re-

newed investor appeal, Mr. Naidu said Andhra Pradesh had unveiled 26 new policies that rebuilt confidence among industries and global investors. The government, he said, had already secured investment commitments worth ₹23 lakh crore with the potential to create nearly 24 lakh jobs. “Today, Andhra Pradesh is witnessing one MoU [Memorandum of Understanding] every day and one groundbreaking ceremony every week,” Mr. Naidu said. “Without development there is no wealth, and without wealth there is no welfare,” he added.



Unwinnable war

The U.S. should pursue a deal with Iran, and not take a maximalist stand

When Donald Trump announced ‘Operation Project Freedom’, aimed at “guiding” stranded merchant vessels out of the Strait of Hormuz, he warned that any interference from Iran would be dealt with “forcefully”. Over the previous weeks, Mr. Trump had issued several ultimatums to Tehran to reopen the waterway, which it closed after the U.S. and Israel launched the war on February 28. As Iran refused to budge, Mr. Trump launched the operation to militarily reopen the strait. But it lasted barely 50 hours. Iran responded by firing at two American destroyers in the strait and attacking a UAE tanker off Oman’s coast. The UAE, a close strategic partner of both the U.S. and Israel, also said it was attacked twice. With the ceasefire coming under strain amid hostilities, Mr. Trump, on Wednesday, said he was pausing the operation “at the request of Pakistan”. While Mr. Trump continues to make sweeping claims about winning the war, the fact that the Strait of Hormuz remains closed – and that the operation to reopen it did not last even three days – points to a very different reality on the ground. The U.S. not only failed to achieve any of its declared objectives during the 40 days of war, but is now grappling with a crisis created by the war itself – the closure of the strait.

Unlike Mr. Trump, who has made several self-contradictory statements since the war began, Iran has remained consistent in its demands. Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei said last week that Iran would “protect” its missile and nuclear capabilities and continue to exercise control over the Strait of Hormuz. Tehran appears convinced that the war has strengthened its hand and that time is on its side. Mr. Trump has made a series of miscalculations. In the first week of the war, he said he would accept nothing short of Iran’s “unconditional surrender”. But as the conflict dragged on, he started demanding a deal. Both sides agreed to a ceasefire on April 8, but the U.S., which imposed a blockade on Iranian ports on April 12, failed to exact any meaningful concession from Iran. Contrary to his rhetoric, he holds few strong cards in this war of attrition. If the crisis persists, it will inflict lasting damage on the U.S. and the global economy, potentially endangering Mr. Trump’s presidency. If he resumes the war, Tehran will retaliate by targeting Gulf kingdoms, which would be catastrophic for the global economy. America is not winning this war. No amount of social media threats or military posturing is going to alter that reality. Washington should recognise this and pursue a deal with Iran based on accommodating mutual demands and reciprocal concessions if it wants to avoid pushing the world economy towards the precipice.

Building hazards

India needs to do more to both prevent and fight fires

Each major fire accident in cities that ends up claiming human lives fleshes out different sets of causative and exacerbating factors. The recent one in Shahdara in East Delhi highlighted a lack of sufficient attention to planning for evacuating buildings in the case of emergencies, mainly fire. Nine people were killed and some 15 were rescued with grievous injuries in that accident. The residential building – still plus four floors comprising eight houses – had security enhancing features that turned out to be deadly: electronic locks on doors that could not be opened; a terrace that was not easily accessible; and metallic grills around the building including on balconies that had to be cut for access by fire service personnel seeking to rescue the victims. A fire in March in Palam, in which nine of an extended family died, highlighted access problems that fire services face in Delhi. The mixed-use building had few of the recommended firefighting facilities required in such buildings. Eyewitnesses complained that the hydraulic lifts used by fire services personnel to access higher floors were malfunctioning. Though the fire services insist they reached the Shahdara accident spot on time, response times have been longer in the capital city at other times. In a fire in Dwarka in 2025, fire engines could not enter the residential society because the name board of the society was blocking them.

While there is certainly a case for reviewing the fire preparedness and fire-fighting capabilities of Delhi, what often goes unaddressed are electrical problems that cause these fires across Indian cities. As summer sets in, air-conditioning blasts are often casually cited as in the Shahdara fire. What often happens is overloading of equipment such as the airconditioner during hot summer days. The wires that are not designed to handle such loads burn due to heat and the circuit breakers that should have tripped the equipment as protection do not do so. In India, the hierarchy of loads and circuit breakers is often not observed as residences are packed with high load equipment beyond what the system can safely carry. The intent is often to keep the equipment running under all conditions whereas tripping of overloaded equipment is a necessary safety feature. City authorities talk of drones and robots to fight fires when even the basic preventive measures are not in place.

The victory of cinema superstar C. Joseph Vijay in the recent State Assembly election marks a watershed moment for politics in Tamil Nadu. Breaking with nearly 60 years of voting for one of only two major Dravidian parties is not just a signal of dissatisfaction but also an abiding quest for enlightened State leadership that recognises the contours of Tamil exceptionalism, and delivers the quality of governance required to meet that imperative.

At the heart of Mr. Vijay’s emphatic win, which resulted in his party, the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), cornering 108 out of the 234 seats in the Assembly, lies a disenchantment with the smug complacency of rule by both the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and, for a decade until 2021, the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK). Between them, the DMK and the AIADMK have alternated periodically in occupying power in Chennai to deliver on the promises of their Dravidian forebears C.N. Annadurai and Periyar E.V. Ramaswamy, which includes values such as state autonomy, freedom from Hindi imposition and other diktats of a distant New Delhi, and welfare policies including the noon-meal scheme and direct transfers to vulnerable groups.

It would be remiss not to mention that this noble project of upliftment of the common man in the State was built on the dubious substructure of a shadow economy encompassing institutionalised corruption and grand larceny on an eyewatering scale. That a former late Chief Minister of the State owned sprawling properties in central London, and that even top global corporations seeking industrial permits admit to being asked for sizeable cash bribes to speed up their licence issues, reveals the institutionalised nature of this rent-seeking model.

Would it then be improper to suggest that the TVK’s surprise win was the result of an electorate growing weary of this Faustian bargain struck with the ruling powers, where they gave with one hand and took with the other?

Yet, there is more to be explained. Why at this moment in time has the public rejected the proven track records of two parties that, in the nearly six decades since they overthrew the Congress and dominated the State, have by and large managed to keep Tamil Nadu on a steady growth path while working towards fulfilling the Dravidian political vision?

Dissecting the victory

There could be several possible factors that might explain the expectation-defying 34.92% vote share that the TVK garnered across virtually every region of the State and likely across most



Narayan Lakshman

At the heart of Mr. Vijay’s emphatic win, lies a disenchantment with the smug complacency of rule by both the DMK and, for a decade until 2021, the AIADMK

demographic cohorts, especially among the youth, and women of all ages and backgrounds.

Firstly, Mr. Vijay presented the over 56 million electors of Tamil Nadu with a unique campaign style, modelled on viral social media marketing strategies. In doing so, he broke with the convention of old-school “offline” campaigning techniques including but not limited to widespread rallies across the State. Mr. Vijay appeared to eschew such public interactions in favour of online messaging on social media platforms such as Instagram, to the point where he courted controversy when, during one of his last campaign speeches, he exhorted young children to compel their parents to vote for the TVK’s ‘whistle’ symbol.

Second, an air of vulnerability and an unspoken sense of victimhood appeared to build up around Mr. Vijay as he pleaded innocence for the deadly stampede at the TVK rally in Karur in September 2025, in which at least 41 people died and many more were injured. This is despite the fact that the actor remained silent for three days following the incident, emerging later from his isolation without an apology for mismanaging a major public event organised by his party, and instead making veiled references to a conspiracy by the DMK-led government. The delay in the release of his film *Jana Nayagan* was similarly attributed to sinister forces seeking to sabotage Mr. Vijay’s commercial prospects and thus undermine his public persona. Such developments appeared to have created momentum for a burgeoning sense of sympathy and outright anger that an outsider to the Dravidian movement framework could be so viciously attacked by incumbent powers.

While these developments certainly give credence to the view that the TVK surge in the election was rooted in a savvy, Gen-Z-driven, social media virality strategy and a strong sentiment of righting an injustice meted out to a political newcomer, it is also important to look at the broader context of tectonic shifts in the political and economic spheres that resulted in the disenchantment with the Dravidian model.

Disillusionment and doubt

The first key factor that might have resulted in voters rejecting the solutions presented by the DMK and the AIADMK for the unprecedented flux in the job market due to technological and economic shocks is hubris. Towards the last few years of each of their terms in office, the public would not have been wrong to be frustrated with the unspoken but implied government view that no other model besides that old combination of mass welfare policies and moderate economic growth driven by a reasonably efficient

Openness, not isolation, is the bedrock of the West

Recent statements from Washington show how global politics is being increasingly framed along civilisational terms. The U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio has referred to the idea of a shared “Western civilisation,” describing the U.S. and Europe as bound by common history, cultural heritage, and institutional traditions. At the same time, U.S. President Donald Trump has amplified comments about countries such as India, China, and Iran in the context of migration and geopolitical competition that reinforce a tendency to interpret global politics in civilisational terms. Taken together, these statements point to a broader shift: global affairs are being interpreted not only through the language of power and interest, but also through civilisational identities.

The appeal of such framing is understandable. It offers a sense of clarity in an era of rapid technological disruption, demographic change, and geopolitical uncertainty. But apparent clarity is not the same as analytical accuracy. Moreover, it is not an entirely new framing either. As early as the 1990s, political scientist Samuel Huntington had argued that global politics would evolve into a “clash of civilisations,” where cultural and religious identities would become the principal fault lines of international relations.

Civilisational explanations can obscure more than they reveal, particularly when they imply that cultural cohesion, rather than institutional adaptability, is the primary source of national strength. A historical record of the modern West suggests otherwise.

A look at history

Much of the West’s post-Cold War dynamism has rested not on homogeneity, but on openness – to talent, ideas, capital, and global competitive pressures. Its advantage has been institutional:



Milinda Moragoda

Former Sri Lankan Cabinet Minister, diplomat and the Founder of the Pathfinder Foundation, a strategic affairs think tank

The West’s advantage lies not only in military alliances or economic scale, but in institutional resilience and its capacity to attract, integrate, and retain talent

the capacity to absorb diversity and convert it into innovation within rules-based systems.

Nowhere is this more evident than in today’s innovation economy. AI, in particular, has become the defining frontier of global competition, shaped by deeply international talent flows and research ecosystems. Companies such as Microsoft, OpenAI, and NVIDIA exemplify systems in which breakthroughs depend on globally sourced expertise, cross-border collaboration, and the ability to attract the most capable minds regardless of origin.

The COVID-19 pandemic underscored this complementary reality: innovation now operates through globally distributed production systems. Rapid vaccine development and distribution, by firms such as Moderna and AstraZeneca, depended on international research networks and global manufacturing ecosystems. In the case of AstraZeneca, large-scale production through partnerships such as that with the Serum Institute of India illustrated how innovation and industrial capacity now operate across borders.

This is not an argument against immigration control. Immigration must be governed effectively, and civic norms must be upheld. But managing diversity is fundamentally different from retreating from it.

In an era of intensifying geopolitical competition, openness remains a critical strategic asset. The West’s advantage lies not only in military alliances or economic scale, but in institutional resilience and its capacity to attract, integrate, and retain talent. Civilisational framing, by contrast, risks misdiagnosing this advantage – privileging identity over capability and boundaries over performance. Demographic realities reinforce this point. Many advanced economies face ageing populations. In this context, immigration is not simply a cultural or political issue, but an economic necessity.

bureaucracy, with the State exchequers looted by political rent-seekers, was the only path forward for progress.

Combine this with the fact that the DMK appeared to be getting ever more deeply mired in dynastic nepotism, with resentment building around the handover of the reins of power to former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin’s son, Udhayanidhi, and the AIADMK chief Edappadi K. Palaniswami’s continued struggle to keep factional infighting from attenuating the cohesive core of his party’s cadre.

A second critical concern of the electors of the State is that the gradual inroads made by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) into Tamil Nadu may be transforming the balance of power therein and eroding the State’s rich tradition of rationalism, anti-ritualism, rejection of upper caste dominance, and opposition to any single religion enjoying disproportionate support from the government. The results for the alliance between the AIADMK and the BJP placed it in third position overall with respectively 47 and one seat for the two parties. This indicates a split in voter preferences on the overall acceptability of the BJP in the State. In this context, the surge towards the TVK might also reflect frustration with the Dravidian majors as they have been unable to come up with a robust strategy to halt the march of the BJP and its ground-level support base, the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS).

Finally, we may be witnessing the dawn of a new era for Dravidian politics as a historical social movement, as the younger generations of voters are likely one step removed from the traditional founding values and ideals of Periyar and Annadurai. Instead, they are by turn gig workers, nomadic factory floor contract operators, apprentices in micro, small and medium enterprises, and entry-level service sector representatives seeking to build a career at a complex moment in Tamil Nadu’s economic evolution. They respond more to a sharply witty Instagram post than a party manifesto published on the official website.

For these voters, and for those swamped by doubts on the capacity of the DMK and the AIADMK to continue to deliver good governance in an era of fundamental socio-economic transformation, Mr. Vijay’s TVK spells promise. Now it remains to be seen whether they will manage to muster the numbers to actually form a government, and if they do, whether the Cabinet that Mr. Vijay assembles and the bureaucratic machinery that has historically excelled in rolling out essential policies for the people will help him make good on the many promises he made.

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LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Floor test

People were under the impression that Mr. Vijay’s TVK party, which emerged as the single largest party in the recently held Tamil Nadu Assembly election, would be called by the Governor to form the government. To the surprise of all, the Governor has insisted that Mr. Vijay produce formal letters of support from enough MLAs before the swearing-in process can move forward.

It is questionable whether the Governor has such powers. The convention is that the Governor has to call the single largest party to form the Government which, in this case, is Mr. Vijay’s party and subject him to the floor test to prove his majority within the shortest possible time. The Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court in the *Bommai* case made it clear that the floor test is the only reliable test by which a

government can prove its majority. Such being the position, the Governor was not right in not inviting Mr. Vijay to form the government.

The Governor has not followed constitutional precedents and has assumed a power which he does not have. It is not out of place to suggest that the Governor’s actions are unconstitutional.

N.G.R. Prasad
Chennai

Challenge for Congress

The Congress led UDF’s return to power with a mandate of 102 seats is a rejection of the LDF’s overbearing leadership. While the previous administration made strides in infrastructure, it collapsed under the weight of internal nepotism and a disconnect from the grassroots. For the UDF, the immediate challenge is to pivot from a campaign team into a cohesive governing

body. The unseemly lust for the Chief Ministerial post displayed by senior leaders has been an embarrassment. The new government also faces a daunting fiscal battle exacerbated by a perceived lack of support from the Central government. There is a growing and justifiable sentiment in Kerala that the Centre is failing to provide the State its due, particularly regarding the 16th FC’s tax devolution.

Delivering on the five guarantees amidst such a strained treasury will require exceptional administrative competence.

S. Padmanabhan
Kochi



Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the full postal address and the full name.

In Pulwama and Poonch, two schools bear the cost of conflict

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

A year on, two schools in Jammu and Kashmir, which bore the brunt of the four-day conflict between India and Pakistan in May last year, stand testimony to the cost of war, tragedy, and trauma.

With Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK) on the other side of the nearby hills, the Christ High School in Poonch is finding it hard to bury the memories of the war. “Who would want a war that leaves children dead? In pursuit of justice for the Pahalgam victims, there was addition to the list of civilian deaths. War exposes the vulnerabilities of human beings,” Father

Shijo, principal of the school, told *The Hindu*.

Three students killed
Three students - Zain Ali and Urwa Fatima, twins who were in Class 5, and Vihaan Bhargav of Class 8 - were killed in Pakistani shelling when they were trying to move to safer locations between May 7 and 11. They were among 21 civilians, including five children, who died on this side of the border during Operation Sindoor, launched against Pakistan following a dastardly terror attack that left 26 civilians, including 25 tourists, dead in Pahalgam.

“Parents of two Class 5 students were evacuating them out of their native vil-

lage when a shell hit them. The third student was on the way to Jammu in a vehicle when splinters from a shell exploded and hit him,” said Father Shijo, as he recalled how the town was hit by shelling for at least two days.

On the first anniversary of Operation Sindoor on Thursday, the staff members of the school, with 1,500 students, held silent prayers for the dead and visited the two families for a remembrance meeting, but avoided any ceremonial function on the campus.

“We did not engage students in any remembrance because it would have recreated the scenes. It took students more than four

months to come out of the trauma. We had to arrange local NGOs for counselling with students to comfort them. We also invited the parents last year, many of whom broke down while sharing their ordeal, to make them unburdened

emotionally,” he said.

The school had to club classes and shut the rooms where the students, who lost their lives, studied. “Students were not willing to study in the same classroom, especially bench-

mates of the deceased. At every sound of a cracker, students would get frightened. They lived in fear for many months,” he said.

The school saw a major power shutdown during the war and relied on its borewell for water. Besides, the shelling shattered the windowpanes and damaged the roof. “We have rebuilt. In fact, we have an underground space in place, but it can accommodate only 200 people,” he added.

Awaiting compensation
Around 141 km away from the Poonch school, another school in Pulwama district tells a story of loss. The school was damaged in a blast, but since the nature of the explosion is still

unknown, it does not fall in the compensation list of those who suffered damage and were provided relief money. A two-storey building of the high school, Madrasa Taleem ul Quran, in Wuyan was hit by an unidentified aerial object before sunrise on May 7.

“I heard in the morning of May 7, the school was hit. I rushed to check the damage but was stopped by the security forces. Later, I saw the computer lab was completely damaged. We acquired a children safety certificate from the education department only after dismantling the building first. It was not safe. However, no compensation was provided,” Shabir Ahmad Sheikh, coordi-

nator of the school, told *The Hindu*. Last June, the school sought financial assistance in the wake of ₹23 lakh loss incurred. “Revenue Department officials visited the school and had promised to provide the financial assistance once provided with the estimation of the school building damages,” read the letter.

Mr. Sheikh said all expansion plans for the school, with 350 students, failed to take off because of the damage. Local legislator Waheed-ur-Rehman Parra too wrote to the government for compensation but to no avail.

With the nature of the blast yet to be established, the school awaits compensation.

From Page One

DMK explores backing AIADMK in hung House

Mr. Stalin, who had initially rejected the proposal, reportedly yielded to pressure from second-line party leaders and invited CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugam, CPI State secretary M. Veerapandian, and VCK leader Thol. Thirumavalavan to his house for discussions on Thursday. The DMK will not join the government, but the allies are free to take a decision, he reportedly told them.

The three parties hold the key to any further churn in Tamil Nadu politics. In fact, their combined support is crucial for both the TVK and the AIADMK to form a government. “A new situation has arisen after the election and we have to decide what should be the position of the Left parties. But it has never been part of our agenda that we would support the AIADMK,” a senior communist leader said.

Currently, the TVK, with the support of the five elected candidates of the Congress, effectively has 112 seats in the 234-member House after accounting for the legal mandate for Mr. Vijay to resign from one of his two seats.

Should the AIADMK aspire to form a government without the support of the BJP’s lone representative, it would require the support of its other allies Pattali Makkal Katchi (four seats) and Amma Makkal Munnetra Kazhagam (one), in addition to that of the DMK (59), the Indian Union Muslim League (two), and the six seats of the CPI, CPI(M), and VCK. It would give the alliance 120 seats.

While the two Communist parties sought time, stating their State committee meetings scheduled for Friday would take a final decision, Mr. Thirumavalavan indicated that he would follow the Communists’ stand.

Growth trajectory
The resolution adopted by the DMK’s MLAs-elect on Thursday further said that Tamil Nadu’s growth trajectory could be sustained only if the welfare schemes implemented by the DMK government over the past five years continued without interruption. “The meeting unanimously empowers the party leader to take an emergency decision, taking into consideration the prevailing political and administrative situation,” the resolution added.

Another resolution sharply criticised the Congress, the DMK’s former ally, accusing it of betrayal after it quit the alliance and extended support to the TVK. “Congress was allotted a Rajya Sabha seat and 28 Assembly seats in the alliance. Yet, within three days of results being declared, it pawned the mandate earned through the hard work of alliance partners to the rival camp. Even during seat-sharing talks, the Congress failed to condemn remarks made against the alliance,” the resolution alleged.

The legislators’ meeting referred to developments in Puducherry, where Congress candidates reportedly contested seats allotted to the DMK. “The rival candidates even met their party leader and sought his blessings. The Congress did not conduct itself sincerely even during the election campaign,” another resolution said.

Cong. high command to choose Kerala CM

Congress MLAs-elect who walked out after the meeting with the AICC members at the Indira Bhavan, the headquarters of the Kerala Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC), remained tight-lipped about their choices for the coveted post. After the Congress-led UDF’s victory in the Assembly elections, a three-way fight had begun for the Chief Minister’s post, with Mr. Satheesan, AICC general secretary (organisation) and Alappuzha MP K.C. Venugopal, and senior leader Ramesh Chennithala in contention. Congress workers held protests in support of Mr. Satheesan in Nettoor in Ernakulam district and at Peravoor in Kannur, the constituency of KPCC president Sunny Joseph.

P.K. Kunhalikutty, general secretary of key UDF ally Indian Union Muslim League, said that the party has conveyed its Chief Minister choice to AICC the observers.

‘Operation Sindoor was a fitting response to terror’

To mark the first anniversary, PM lauds the armed forces for their bravery and dedication in attacking terrorist camps and military infrastructure in Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

To mark the first anniversary of Operation Sindoor, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday lauded the armed forces for their bravery and dedication in attacking terrorist camps and military infrastructure in Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir.



PM Narendra Modi highlighted the professionalism and preparedness of the armed forces during the operation. FILE PHOTO

In a post on X, Mr. Modi said that a year ago, India’s armed forces displayed “unparalleled courage, precision and resolve” during Operation Sindoor and gave a fitting response to those responsible for the Pahalgam terror attack.

He said the entire nation saluted the forces for their bravery and dedication. Mr. Modi added that Operation Sindoor reflected India’s uncompromising stand against terrorism and reaffirmed the country’s commitment to national security.

Mr. Modi also highlighted the professionalism, preparedness and growing jointness among the armed forces during the operation. He said the mis-

sion underlined the strength India had achieved through self-reliance in the defence sector under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative.

Late on the night of May 6 and into the early hours of May 7, 2025, India launched Operation Sindoor – a coordinated military offensive involving the Army, Air Force, and the Navy.

Mr. Modi changed his display picture across social media platforms to honour the courage and valour of the Indian armed forces.

The Prime Minister also urged citizens to change their profile pictures on social media as a tribute to the forces and the success of the operation.

Exclusive footage
Marking the occasion, the Indian Air Force released exclusive footage of Operation Sindoor at 1.05 a.m on Thursday. The 88-second video showcased precision strikes, coordinated military action and operational preparedness during the high-intensity counter-terror operation.

Learnt several important lessons during conflict with Pakistan: military officials

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI



Lt. Gen. Rajiv Ghai

On the first anniversary of Operation Sindoor, senior military officials asserted that India’s response to cross-border terrorism had fundamentally altered the security landscape, with Lieutenant-General Rajiv Ghai declaring that no terror sanctuary inside Pakistan remains safe anymore.

Addressing a joint press conference in Jaipur with senior officers from the Indian Army, Air Force and Navy, Lieutenant-General Ghai, who served as the Director-General of Military Operations during Operation Sindoor, said the operation was “not an end, but just the beginning”.

He stated that the operation continues in terms of preparedness and strategic planning. “We have imbibed several lessons during Operation Sindoor and accordingly, changes are

being made. The operation will remain in progress for as long as required,” he said.

Detailing the scale of the military action, Air Marshal Awadhesh Kumar Bharti said the Indian Air Force destroyed nine terrorist camps on May 7 and later struck 11 Pakistani airfields. “We destroyed 13 of their aircraft, either on the ground or in the air, including one high-value airborne asset at a record distance of over 300 kilometres,” he said, ad-

ding that evidence of the strikes was available for the world to see.

Vice-Admiral A.N. Pramod said Operation Sindoor exposed the limitations of Pakistan’s nuclear deterrence narrative. He stated that India’s use of long-range precision weapons demonstrated its ability to strike deep inside hostile territory while maintaining calibrated escalation.

He also highlighted the growing importance of uncrewed and autonomous systems in modern warfare and stressed the need for accelerated integration of such technologies into India’s operational framework.

The External Affairs Ministry affirmed that India’s position on the Indus Waters Treaty was consistent. The IWT was kept in abeyance in response to Pakistan’s continued sponsorship of terrorism.

Was a ‘proper debate’ held in Parliament on CEC and ECs appointment law, asks SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI



The Supreme Court on Thursday asked if there had been a “proper debate” in Parliament about the “ethos” of its 2023 judgment that took the appointment of members of the Election Commission out of the exclusive hands of the political executive, namely, “the party which not unnaturally has an interest in perpetuating itself in power”.

In a 2023 judgment in *Anoop Baranwal versus Union of India*, a Constitution Bench of the court had replaced the mechanism of the President appointing the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and Election Commissioners (ECs) on the sole advice of the Prime Minister with a more participatory appointment process involving a three-member selection committee of the Prime Minister,

the Opposition Leader in the Lok Sabha, and the Chief Justice of India. The court had said the committee would be in place till Parliament brought in a law to replace it.

The Union government had brought in a law which reverted to the dominant role of the executive in the appointments of the CEC and ECs. Under the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service, and Term of Office) Act of 2023, the CJI was replaced in the

selection committee by a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister.

“But was there a proper debate in Parliament about the *Anoop Baranwal* judgment? Is the ethos voiced in the judgment reflected in the Parliamentary debates... That is not clear,” said Justice Dipankar Datta, heading a Bench comprising himself and Justice Satish Chandra Sharma.

Senior advocate Shadan Farasat, appearing for an intervenor, said the passing of the law had been preceded by an *en masse* suspension of Opposition MPs. “There was no proper debate in the Parliament,” he said.

“A majority of the Opposition was suspended. [Al-MIM MP Asaduddin] Owaisi was the sole objector,” advocate Prashant Bhushan, appearing for Association for Democratic Reforms, submitted.

Nida Khan, accused in TCS case, arrested

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Over 40 days after a first information report was registered against her in a rape and sexual exploitation case, suspended TCS employee Nida Khan was ta-

ken into police custody in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar late on Thursday night.

The arrest was made in a joint operation by the Nashik SIT, the Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar Crime Branch and the Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar Police Commissioner. “Ms. Khan has been taken into custody from Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar. We are in the process of completing the legal action now,” said Assistant Commissioner of Police Sandip Mitke, who heads the Nashik Police

SIT. She would be produced in court thereafter.

Recently, a Nashik court had refused Ms. Khan’s anticipatory bail application after the prosecution claimed that she had links in Malaysia and in Malegaon.



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APPEAL



“Constitutional conscience owes no apology to technicalities. Delaying the swearing-in of Vijay is a political outrage and a constitutional heresy,” he further said.

Governor must ensure formation of a stable government in a State

The apex court and the Sarkaria Commission have highlighted the importance of giving Governors



“Suppose after general elections, no political party or coalition of parties or groups is able to secure absolute majority in the Legislative Assembly and despite the Governor’s exploring the alternatives,

The Rameshwar Prasad case flagged the criticism recorded in the Sarkaria Commission that Governors have, more often than

“Coalition governments are in place in several States and in fact at the Centre. There is nothing wrong in post-poll adjustments, and when ideological similarity weighs with any political party to support another political party though there was no pre-poll alliance... There is nothing wrong in it,” the court has observed.

T.N. govt. formation: CPI(M), CPI chiefs denounce Arlekar

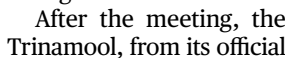
CPI general secretary D. Raja said the strength of a government has to be tested on the floor of the Assembly and not in the Governor's house. "The mandate is in favour of TVK. This should be recog-



Since the verdict threw up a hung Assembly, the TVK has been working to gather support from other parties to form a government in Tamil Nadu.

Akhilesh Yadav calls on Mamata Banerjee, says Trinamool fought well

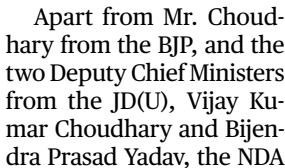
"*Didi* is not a person to be disappointed. She is a



Following the Trinamool's loss in the recently concluded West Bengal election, several leaders of the INDIA bloc, including Sonia Gandhi, reached out to Ms. Banerjee. Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) leader Tejashwi Yadav, Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leader Arvind Kejriwal, and Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM) chief and Chief Minister of Jharkhand Hemant Soren had campaigned for the Trinamool Congress.

Nitish's son among 32 Ministers inducted into new Bihar Cabinet

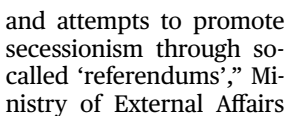
The new Cabinet retains most faces from the previous Cabinet under Mr. Nitish Kumar, with some new faces, including Mr.



The new Cabinet reflects a combination of castes, communities, and gender, with a focus on representation of Other Backward Classes, Extremely Backward Classes, the upper castes, Scheduled Castes, and women.

'Canada must act against anti-India extremist elements'

"India has repeatedly urged the Canadian government to take effective action against anti-Indian extremist elements operating from its soil. This includes addressing the issue of glorification of violence, threats against Indian leaders and diplomats, vandalism of places of worship,



movement and notes that Canada-based Khalistani extremist (CBKE) groups continue to pose a national security threat not only to

“India is a democracy that adheres to international norms and respects the sovereignty of other nations...”

INBRIEF



CAG conducting audit of 101 cities to assess ease of living

India is conducting a special audit of 101 cities to assess ease of living from the citizen's perspective, Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) K. Sanjay Murthy said on Thursday. At the 5th BRICS Supreme Audit Institutions (SAI) Leaders' Summit here, Mr. Murthy said the CAG of India is auditing multi-modal transport and first-mile, last-mile logistics, in partnership with institutions like the IIT and IIM, and the World Bank. India is hosting the three-day summit under the overarching theme 'Ease of Living with a Focus on Urban Mobility'. Convened during India's year of BRICS Chairmanship 2026 by the Office of the CAG, it brings together 42 delegates, including Heads of SAI's from BRICS member countries, to deliberate on audit themes of shared relevance, exchange best practices, and strengthen public financial oversight. PTI

Pronto raises \$20 million as valuation doubles from March

On-demand home services start-up Pronto has raised an additional \$20 million in its Series B round from venture capitalist Lachy Groom, doubling its valuation to \$200 million in just two months. The platform, backed by General Catalyst, offers services such as laundry, kitchen prep and home cleaning from ₹125, with workers available within 15 minutes. It competes with Urban Company's Insta Help and Lightspeed-backed Snabbitt. Pronto raised \$25 million in March from Epiq Capital, Glade Brook Capital, General Catalyst and Bain Capital Ventures at a \$100 million valuation. The firm will use much of the fresh capital to scale its workforce, CEO Anjali Sardana said, adding the platform is "very supply-constrained." "We went from 3,000 bookings a day at the beginning of December to now over 26,000 bookings a day...we've been scaling supply quite fast, but it has not kept up with demand," she said. REUTERS

Coromandel Intl Q4 net profit at ₹115 cr.

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Agriculture solutions provider Coromandel International reported consolidated net profit for March quarter stood at ₹115 crore compared with ₹578 crore a year earlier.

The lower net profit came on a 19% rise in total income to ₹6,068 crore. Under exceptional items, the firm reported a ₹70.56 crore loss against ₹346.77 crore gain in the year-earlier period.

For fiscal ended March, net profit was 8% lower at ₹1,898 crore on a total income which was 30% higher at ₹31,827 crore.

₹2 dividend

The company declared a final dividend of ₹2 per equity share (face value of ₹1



S. Sankarasubramanian

each). Earlier, in February, it had paid an interim dividend of ₹9 per share.

"Coromandel's nutrient business delivered a steady performance in FY26, navigating a dynamic operating environment marked by supply disruptions, volatile raw material prices and sharp currency movements," MD and CEO S. Sankarasubramanian said in a press release.

Apple draws ₹100-cr. 'green' plan for India

Mini Tejaswi
BENGALURU

Apple announced a slew of clean energy and environmental initiatives in India, including investments to expand renewable energy infrastructure, cut plastic pollution and foster green entrepreneurship in India.

These include a partnership with renewable energy developer CleanMax. Apple's initial investment of ₹100 crore would support the development of more than 150 megawatts of renewable energy capacity – enough to power an average of 1.50 lakh Indian households each year – with opportunity to expand in the coming years, said the iPhone maker.

Sarah Chandler, Apple's VP of environment and supply chain innovation,

Apple's ₹100 crore investment would support development of over 150 MW renewable energy

said, "We're proud to expand our efforts to invest in India's clean energy economy and protect the country's precious natural resources."

The new initiatives are expected to support Apple's ambitious goal to be carbon neutral across its entire footprint by 2030.

In order to reduce plastic pollution, Apple is working with WWF-India and supporting recovery-focused recycling and waste management initiatives that prioritise environmental and social safeguards, the firm said.

Kotak Bank gets RBI nod to buy 9.99% each in AUSFB, Federal Bank

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Kotak Mahindra Bank has received RBI approval to acquire up to 9.99% each in AU Small Finance Bank and Federal Bank.

In separate regulatory filings on Thursday, AU Small Finance Bank (AU SFB) and Federal Bank announced that they have received the approval letter from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on May 6.

'Aggregate holding'

Kotak Mahindra Bank Ltd (KMBL) (along with its subsidiaries, the funds/



Banking on banks: Federal Bank shares closed 1.36% up at ₹297.10 on the BSE on Thursday.

schemes managed by KMBL's subsidiaries, collectively referred to as 'Kotak Mahindra Group') has

received the RBI nod to acquire 'aggregate holding' of up to 9.99% of the paid-up share capital or voting

rights in AU SFB, AU Small Finance Bank said.

Similarly, Federal Bank said the Reserve Bank of India accorded approval to Kotak Mahindra Bank for acquiring 'aggregate holding' of up to 9.99% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights of the bank.

Shares surge on BSE

Shares of AU Small Finance Bank closed at ₹1,032.25, up 0.76% over the previous close on the BSE.

Federal Bank shares closed 1.36% up at ₹297.10 on the BSE. Kotak Mahindra Bank scrip closed 0.84% higher at ₹379.35.

Business

'Compliance norms could derail EU FTA deal benefits'

Calling the agreement the 'mother of all deals,' EU's Ambassador to India Hervé Delphin says it is, however, missing a chapter on investments; the deal could be implemented by early 2027, he says

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

While hailing the India-European Union (EU) Free Trade Agreement (FTA) as creating a joint market comprising one quarter of global Gross Domestic Product (GDP), the EU's ambassador to India Hervé Delphin also struck a note of caution over regulatory hurdles and "unfinished business" that could overshadow the benefits of the deal.

Speaking at an event organised by the Federation of European Business in India, Mr. Delphin also said that the FTA would likely be implemented in "early 2027", a timeline that sources in the Indian government also confirm.

Negotiations on the FTA



Conditions apply: Conformity requirements should serve the purpose and not be barriers, said Mr. Delphin. BY ARRANGEMENT

were concluded in January this year.

"Both sides must ensure that the agreement is implemented smoothly and in good faith," he said. "For this to materialise, we need to align on a pro-FTA mindset and approach across our systems: customs procedures or conformity requirements should serve their purpose

and not be used as trade barriers."

"If administrative procedures are too burdensome businesses may consider that cost of compliance outweighs the benefits of preferential tariffs, in which case the FTA potential would be lost," Mr. Delphin added. "That would be a missed opportunity."

Speaking a little more

about the opportunity created by the FTA, the Ambassador said that the agreement would create a free trade zone covering nearly two billion people and a quarter of global GDP. "It will be the largest FTA ever signed by either side. For all these reasons it has been rightly billed the 'mother of all deals,' he said.

However, he also pointed out some of the shortcomings in the deal.

"The FTA does not cover all relevant areas," he said. "We need to look at 'unfinished business' and 'beyond FTA'. Investment is the main case in point... There is regrettably no FTA chapter on investment liberalisation in non-services sectors, which would have given investors more assurance and predictability."

'Banks should brace for risks emerging from Mythos AI'

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Banks should make risk management a part of their core culture in order to face cybersecurity threats emerging from the newly introduced Mythos AI model, said Secretary in the Department of Financial Services M. Nagaraju.

"Risk management should be embedded in the culture of every bank," Mr. Nagaraju said while speaking at an IBA event here on Thursday.

The role of banks would become "more critical" as India continues to grow despite geopolitical challenges, he said.

"I hope the banking community is prepared well to face [any threat] in case Mythos is released publicly in the country...One successful cyberattack can cascade quickly across in-

Risk management should be embedded in every bank's culture, said Mr. Nagaraju

stitutions and markets," Mr. Nagaraju said.

Speaking on India's exposure to the West Asia conflict, Mr. Nagaraju said, "Most of the areas have been impacted except for certain areas like educational institutions and the horticulture sector... some of these sectors were actually not impacted by the West Asia crisis."

"These sectors will not be included in the Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme announced recently," the Secretary said.

"For the rest of the sectors, the scheme is available, and they can avail the benefit," he added.

Walmart sourced goods worth over \$40 bn from India since 2019: CEO

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Walmart Inc said it had sourced goods worth more than \$40 billion from India since 2019.

"We've already sourced more than \$40 billion in goods from India and are focused on strengthening entrepreneur and supplier capabilities, raising compliance and quality stan-



John Furner

dards, and helping scale manufacturing so more Indian businesses are ready to export," said President

and CEO John Furner. Speaking at Walmart Growth Summit in New Delhi on Thursday, Mr. Furner said this work was expanding economic opportunity and connecting innovative businesses in India with customers around the world.

Walmart also announced that under its Vriddhi Supplier Development Programme, the

company had trained over 1,15,000 MSMEs across the country since its launch in 2019, equipping them with digital capabilities, critical business skills, and access to new markets. The company has a mandate to train over 170,000 MSMEs by 2028, under the programme to strengthen the pipeline of MSMEs that have the ambition to export to new markets.

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Cummins pleased with SRH's bowling effort against PBKS



Skipper Shreyas rues dropped catches after loss to Sunrisers



Australian players to stay back in IPL despite Pakistan ODI series



Marsh, Prince excel as Super Giants end losing run

CM
YK

INBRIEF



Sinner demands 'respect' from Slams in prize money row

Jannik Sinner called on Thursday for Grand Slam tournaments to show tennis players respect in a row over prize money, but stopped short of calling for a boycott of the sport's major events. "It's more about respect. Because I think we give much more than we are getting back. It's not only for the top players; it's for all of us players. So I do understand players talking about boycott because it's somewhere we also need to start."

Defensive lapses, missed chances cost India dear

Defensive errors and lapses at crucial moments proved costly as India had a difficult start to its AFC Under-17 Asian Cup football campaign, suffering a 4-0 defeat against Australia in Jeddah on Wednesday.
The result: India 0 lost to Australia 4 (Luke Becvinovski 4, Max Court 29-pen, Luka Demuth 74, Henrique Oliveira 86).

Vinesh's return from retirement doubtful

Vinesh Phogat's return to competitive wrestling looks doubtful as the Wrestling Federation of India has raised doubts over her eligibility on the basis of a United World Wrestling regulation on retired athletes. The 31-year-old, who retired following the 2024 Paris Olympics, reversed her decision on Dec. 12, 2025. Vinesh got a notice from the International Testing Agency for missing an out-of-competition dope test on Dec. 18, 2025. "Any retired wrestler who wishes to return to competition shall announce it to UWW at least six months before and be available for doping tests during this period," says a UWW rule.

IOC lifts ban on Belarusians competing in the Olympics

The IOC on Thursday lifted restrictions on Belarusian athletes competing in the Olympics, although restrictions on Russian athletes remain in place.

Indian women stun Korea, enter the recurve final

ARCHERY

Sports Bureau

The Indian recurve women's team, consisting of Olympians Ankita Bhakat and Deepika Kumari and rookie Kumkum Mohod, toppled a formidable Korea on its way to the final and assured the country of a medal at the Archery World Cup Stage-2 in Shanghai on Thursday.

The Indian trio defeated Uzbekistan 6-2 and Vietnam 5-4 before toppling top-ranked Korea5-1 in the semifinals.

India will meet host China in the final on Sunday.

The results: Recurve: Team: Men: India (B. Dhiraj, Tarundeep Rai, Yashdeep Bhoge) got a bye (first round), lost to Bangladesh 2-6 (second round).

Ajitesh along with lower-order leads Globe Trotters' recovery

FIRST DIVISION

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Globe Trotters recovered from early setbacks to post 219 for seven against MRC-A at stumps on the opening day of the TNCA first division league final for the Raja of Palayampatti Shield at Gojan-B ground here on Thursday.
Opting to field, MRC-



Terrific trio: Ankita, Deepika and Kumkum rose to the occasion. WORLD ARCHERY

Women: India (Ankita Bhakat, Kumkum Mohod, Deepika Kumari) bt Uzbekistan 6-2 (first round), bt Vietnam 5-4 (shoot-off: 28-25) (quarterfinal), bt Korea 5-1 (semifinal).
Mixed: India (Ankita Bhakat, B. Dhiraj) got a bye (first round), lost

duced Trotters to 74 for three by lunch and continued to chip away with regular wickets through the middle session.

Composed knock G. Ajitesh steadied the innings with a composed half-century (55, 78b, 7x4). His knock helped Trotters rebuild after the shaky start and carried the side to 169 for six at tea. Contributions from the lower-order ensured that



Unstoppable: Dembele, right, caps off a sweeping counter-attack with the opening goal. AP

Dembele's early strike helps PSG edge Bayern

The holder largely succeeds in subduing the German giant's attacking threat, despite Kane's stoppage-time equaliser; the host loses cool over some first-half refereeing decisions

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
MUNICH

Holder Paris Saint-Germain set up a Champions League final against Arsenal after a 1-1 second-leg draw at Bayern Munich secured a 6-5 aggregate victory on Wednesday.

PSG exploded on the counter less than three minutes in and Ballon d'Or winner Ousmane Dembele put Luis Enrique's visitors ahead on the night and two goals up in the tie.

PSG largely succeeded in subduing Bayern's attacking threat, despite Harry Kane's stoppage-time goal.

On its return to Munich's Allianz Arena, the scene of its greatest triumph against Inter Milan in last year's final, PSG once again emphasised its excellence in a competition it coveted without success for so long.

PSG's bull run

Enrique's side continues its march to the top with another stellar show

1 Paris Saint-Germain is the first French club to make successive Champions League (CL) finals. It is also the first Ligue 1 team to advance to three European Cup/CL title deciders

1 PSG is the first reigning champion to reach the summit clash since Real Madrid in 2017-18

3 The French powerhouse has entered the final for the third time since 2019-20

7 Kvaratskhelia has now scored or assisted in seven consecutive CL knockout fixtures

7 Bayern striker Kane's equaliser helped him extend his scoring streak in the elite club competition to seven matches

44 PSG's tally of goals during this CL campaign (16 matches), one short of the record set by Barcelona (1999-2000)

The French giant will be the favourites to lift the trophy for a second successive season when it faces Premier League leader Arsenal on May 30 in Budapest.

The French giant is hoping to become only the second back-to-back winners since 1990, after Real Madrid.

Bayern was angered by some first-half refereeing

decisions but was largely toothless in attack.

The six-time European champions has still not reached the final since beating PSG in the 2020 showpiece in Lisbon.

Both sides were playing their 52nd match of the season in all competitions - not even counting last summer's Club World Cup - but only the hosts looked weary.

AROUND THE CITY

Devaraj impresses for United in losing cause

United CC off-spinner M. Devaraj produced an impressive spell of five for 44, but his effort went in vain as Jaya Education Group registered a convincing 69-run victory in the TNCA-Tiruvallur DCA fourth division qualifier-2 match on Thursday.

In the 21st Lucas TVS Tiruvallur DCA trophy Group-B clash, CPCL thrashed India Japan Lighting by eight wickets, thanks to Haridass' five-wicket haul (5/20).

The scores: IV-div (qualifier-2): Jaya Education Group 186/9 in 30 overs (M. Gowtham 46, S. Sridharan 64, M. Devaraj 5/44) bt United 117/8 in 30 overs (V. Dinesh Kumar 3/20). 21st Lucas TVS Tiruvallur DCA Trophy Group-B: India Japan Lighting 89 in 17.4 overs (M. Haridass 5/20) lost to CPCL 91/2 in 10.5 overs (B. Ganesh Kumar 44 n.o.).

Garnet emerges third division champion

The TNCA third division league championship concluded with Garnet CC emerging as the overall champion after defeating Rising Stars CC by four wickets in the promotion playoff match for the CR Pattabhiraman Shield. Garnet had earlier dominated the third division 'B' Zone for the G. Parthasarathy Shield, winning all 11 of its league matches to finish on top with 44 points. Singam Puli CC secured second place with eight wins from 11 matches and 32 points.



Triumphant: Garnet CC which won the overall TNCA third division league championship.



Haridass (CPCL, 5/20); Devaraj (United, 5/44).



Lishan (SJCA, 109); Viswajith (LMCA, 139 n.o.).

In the third division 'A' Zone for the CR Rangachari Shield, Rising Stars finished as table-topper after winning nine of its 11 matches and ending with 36 points. National RC also won nine matches and finished with 36 points but had to settle for second place. Meanwhile, in the relegation play-off, Aruna CC defeated Perungalathur CC by four wickets, resulting in Perungalathur's relegation to the fourth division for the forthcoming season. The scores: Rising Stars 251 in 47.3 overs (B. Swadesh 67, N. Karmegam 57, V. S. Varun 50, S. Boopalan 4/37) lost to Garnet 253/6 in 44.3 overs (R. Vivek 67, T. Kapil 45, S. Adityanathan 51, A. V. Abilash 34 n.o., Rohan Ravi Bhutra 3/36). Relegation Playoff Match: Perungalathur 226/9 in 50 overs (G. Rajesh 42, A.K. Nitin 36, P.S. Nirmal Kumar 3/40, R. Adithya 3/53) lost to Aruna 228/6 in 41.2

overs (Sanjay Venkateshwar 59, G. Gourav Sharma 34, R. Krishna Moorthy 37). Relegated teams: TI Cycles S & RC (III-A), Fox Trotters CC (III-B) & Perungalathur CC (III-A). Lishan's ton lights up SJCA's win S. Lishan's 109 powered SJCA to a huge 154-run win over PSCA in the u-12 category of the 20th Freyer International Logistics LMCA Trophy on Thursday. In the u-16 clash, A.L. Viswajith's unbeaten 139 guided LMCA to a comfortable eight-wicket victory over SJCA. The scores: U-12: GFCA 183/2 in 25 overs (Kushal 68, Dheeraj 97) bt I Intensity 93 in 19 overs. SJCA 267/4 in 25 overs (Lishan 109, Mohit 50, Aaryan Rao 50) bt PSCA 113 in 24.1 overs. I Intensity 92/9 in 25 overs lost to SPRCA 93/0 in 9.1 overs (S. Navish 56 n.o.). U-14: GFCA 135/6 in 25 overs (M.S. Sudheep Shivanand 32, M.

Humesh 57) bt I Intensity 77 in 22.1 overs (S.A. Kavin Roger 3/9). SJCA 210/7 in 24.4 overs (T. Siddeshwar 50, Aaryan Rao 35, B. Pranav 50) bt PSCA 146/8 in 25 overs (A.R. Dharmik Shanmanth 42). Gupta 124 in 24.4 overs (V. Jai Kavin 31, Gowshikan Sathish 3/25) lost to I Intensity 125/2 in 17.1 overs (V. Kaushik 34, Rethish Sathish 58 n.o.). U-16: I Intensity 203/8 in 25 overs (Gowshikan Sathish 36) bt LMCA 119 in 18 overs (Sai Devesh 31). SJCA 210/4 in 25 overs (Dhairya Malhotra 62, P.R. Krishna Badrinath 69) lost to LMCA 213/2 in 23.2 overs (A.L. Viswajith 139 n.o., Aariv Jain 38). Thirunavukarasu and Tamil Selvan on top The pair of Thirunavukarasu and Tamil Selvan finished first with 65.80%, while Lakshman and Uma Maheshwari (64.77%) and Jaishankar and Maya Iyer (63.07%) finished second and third respectively in the IIT Alumni Open Bridge tournament recently. ENGAGEMENTS Cricket: TNCA first division multi-day (final), MRC-A vs Globe Trotters, 9.30 a.m., Gojan-B.



Glory beckons: Arteta is eyeing a first-ever CL title for Arsenal while Enrique hopes to guide PSG to a second straight triumph. AP, AFP

Master tacticians Arteta and Enrique lift Arsenal, PSG

Natalia Hannah Rice
CHENNAI

Mikel Arteta and Luis Enrique, two Spanish tacticians who have been on the rise, have set up a mouth-watering Champions League final contest. It's another reward for their grind over the years.

When Arteta arrived at Arsenal in 2019, the club looked directionless. Its football lacked structure, recruitment appeared reactive, and performance fluctuated wildly. His rival Enrique, in 2023, inherited a different problem at Paris Saint-Germain (PSG), a side that was stacked with individual brilliance but was often accused of lacking collective identity.

Years later, both managers have reshaped their teams with distinct philosophies.

Arsenal has become one of Europe's most tactically disciplined sides. Built on aggressive pressing, positional rotations and controlled possession, Arsenal plays with a clarity that mirrors its head coach's personality. Players are recruited not only for their talent, but because they are tactically compatible.

Enrique's task at PSG

has been equally tough. For years, the French club's project revolved around superstar forwards and individual efforts. But Enrique has attempted to move away from that dependence, prioritising intensity, balance and collective belief. Since the 55-year-old's takeover, PSG has been attacking quicker and defending with greater organisation than in the seasons that preceded.

What could make the CL title decider compelling is not merely the quality on the pitch but the ideological imprint both bosses have left on their clubs so far.

In Arteta and Enrique, Arsenal and PSG have found managers willing to demand patience, discipline and long-term commitment. The final, therefore, is also likely to be a clash of identities. It could be a reflection of the coaches who have spent years reshaping institutions until the football finally began to resemble their vision.

Their previous meeting ended in a 3-1 semifinal aggregate victory for PSG in 2024-25. Will Enrique outclass Arteta once again, or will the latter script history with Arsenal?

From the doldrums to the top, Sunrisers' stunning rise

The 2016 champion, which began IPL 2026 with three defeats in its first four outings, has embarked on a fabulous run that has netted them six victories on the bounce; Nitish's all-round efficacy is a much under-rated but massive contribution to the franchise's impressive performances



NAGARA GOPAL

R. Kaushik

A disappointing first fortnight, a spectacular three and a half weeks thereafter. It's been a stunning turnaround for Sunrisers Hyderabad, the 2016 champions who began IPL 2026 with three defeats in their first four outings, but have since embarked on a fabulous run that has netted them six victories on the bounce.

What makes their revival even more special is the fact that they have seamlessly embraced a change in captaincy too, with Pat Cummins effortlessly slipping back into the role he has performed with aplomb in the past. Well before the start of this season, it was evident that Australia's Test and One-Day International skipper would miss the early part of IPL 2026, recovering as he was from a back injury that restricted his participation to just one Ashes Test in the Australian summer and forced him out of the T20 World Cup, where Australia crashed out in the first round following defeats to Zimbabwe and Sri Lanka.

Kishan's second coming

With Cummins guaranteed to miss the initial few matches of the tournament, the Sunrisers management bestowed the captaincy on Ishan Kishan, a late entrant to the franchise but clearly establishing his leadership credentials in no uncertain terms. His own career at a crossroads until a year and a half back, Kishan took charge of the Jharkhand team in the domestic season gone by. Not only that, he masterminded a wonderful run in the 20-over Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy that culminated in his state emerging triumphant in the tournament for the first time. The icing on the cake? A century by Kishan himself in the title round.

Such were the numbers he stacked up during that tournament that India were compelled to turn to him just before they announced their squad for the defence of the T20 World Cup, won in Bridgetown under Rohit Sharma in June 2024. Finally acknowledging their mistake in trying to resurrect Shubman Gill's patchy T20I career, Ajit Agarkar's selection panel decided it was time to part ways, even if only temporarily, with India's Test and ODI leader.

Out went the call to Kishan, the final evidence that he was deemed to have served penance for disobeying the BCCI diktat and refraining from playing domestic cricket in the early part of 2024. Kishan was stripped of his central contract for his temerity; that he was now being considered as one of the key batting cogs at the World Cup was a shot in the arm for the little wicketkeeper-batter, who played his part in India becoming the first team to win the World Cup in the shortest format on home turf.

SRH placing faith in Kishan was an

extension of the BCCI recognising his worth, though Kishan's captaincy career with his new franchise got off to a rocky start. Despite a whirlwind 80 in the tournament opener before his innings was halted in full flow by a screamer from Phil Salt, Kishan found himself on the losing side as defending champions Royal Challengers Bengaluru hunted down a target of 202 with consummate ease. Victory in the next outing, at home against Kolkata Knight Riders, was cancelled out by consecutive losses to Lucknow Super Giants and Punjab Kings as Hyderabad found themselves in the doldrums, their power-packed batting line-up let down by the munificence of the bowling in which old warhorses Harshal Patel and Jaydev Unadkat no longer posed the same threat with their variations as they had in the past.

Debutants' dazzle

With their campaign hanging from the slenderest of threads and Cummins still some distance away from returning to match play, Hyderabad worked the changes, investing in uncapped Indian quicks. At the very first time of asking, they struck gold with debutants Praful Hinge and Sakib Hussain running amok against the formidable Rajasthan Royals top order at their Uppal base in Hyderabad. Hinge became the first bowler in the history of the competition to take three wickets in the first over of a match - needless to say, also the first debutant to pick up three scalps in his very first over - on his way to a four-wicket haul. Sakib followed suit with four wickets of his own as Rajasthan were swept aside by a mile, kickstarting a run that has made the Hyderabad outfit one of the frontrunners for a playoff berth.

Hinge's three first-over victims were Vaibhav Suryavanshi, the 15-year-old prodigy who courted a golden duck, Dhruv Jurel and South African Lhuan-dre Pretorius. Sakib had Jaiswal caught at the deep third-man fence in the second over as both unheralded quicks justified the faith of the leadership group. It was just the tonic the southern team required to rejuvenate a flagging run; with the rest of the bowling group led by Sri Lankan Eshan Malinga holding its own, left-arm wrist-spinner Shivang Kumar finding life in the fast lane to his liking and Cummins showing that he was never really away despite missing the first eight matches, Hyderabad have ticked over like a well-oiled machine.

It will be no exaggeration to place the credit for the dramatic upswing in fortunes at the feet of the bowling group, in which Nitish Kumar too has been a vital contributor. In the off-season, Nitish worked assiduously on his bowling, working on getting his pace up and embracing greater consistency in his sessions with Steffan Jones, a specialised pace coach. The results are there for all to

see; the all-rounder has been used in various capacities, including as a new-ball operator, and he has responded to every challenge with a great heart and no mean exhibitions of skill. Hyderabad have become primarily a pace-heavy bowling unit, not unlike many others in the IPL for whom spin has become a secondary suit, and with all the parts ticking over nicely, they are reaping handsome rewards as the competition hurtles towards the business end.

Fearsome batting unit

If hardly a word has been written so far about the munificence of batting riches that Hyderabad boast, it's almost a back-handed compliment because so many have come to take their batting might almost for granted. In Abhishek Sharma and Travis Head --- TraviShek, as they are called - they have arguably the most destructive opening pair of the tournament. They were the first to buck the oft-touted significance of having a left-right combination at the top. The two left-handers complement each other superbly, instinctively knowing when the other is in the mood and backing off just that little without trying to compete with their partner for impact and effort. Rather than competing with one another, they support and feed off each other. Abhishek is an acknowledged slayer of spin without being too far behind when it comes to taking on pace, while Head is a marauder at the top of the order, though he hasn't been at his absolute best this season.

In recent games, the Australian too is showing signs of rediscovering top touch, which isn't the best news for the other teams in the fray that lie ahead of Hyderabad. Following this destructive left-handed tandem is a third left-hander in Kishan; between them, this trio has scored more than 1,200 runs already this season, with Head's not unimpressive 174.39 the least of the three strike-rates. Abhishek, who has 43 fours and 36 sixes, is striking at 210.17 and Kishan at 186.75; there is no more dangerous top-three in the tournament, and it is showing no signs of slowing up.

Add the wonderfully strokeful South African Heinrich Klaasen to the mix, and we get a line-up better than the best in the business. You'd think someone with 475 runs from 11 innings (Abhishek) would be on top of the run-making charts, at least as far as the franchise is concerned, but you'd be wrong in this instance. Klaasen, the gifted right-hander whose season began somewhat scratchily but who is now striking the ball as well as anyone else, has an astonishing 494 runs at a team-high average of 54.88. He is only striking at 157.32, which is quite a handful in normal course, but that relatively low strike-rate compared to the three batters above him is offset by his supreme consistency, which has already netted him five half-centuries.

Hyderabad have also been able to eke out meaningful and impactful runs down the order from Nitish, who has scored his 222 runs at a strike-rate of 166.91. His all-round efficacy is a much under-rated but massive contribution to his franchise going to the top of the table after its seventh win from 11 games - he also has seven wickets against his name - and singles out Hyderabad as the team to look out for, and beat, as the race for a place in the top four intensifies, especially after a hat-trick of losses for once high-flying Punjab Kings, who suddenly have embarked on a downward spiral.

Opinion has remained divided on the role of momentum in the 20-over game. Many feel that once a team gets on a roll, it becomes difficult to stop, a view endorsed by those who are on a winning streak. Others, like Punjab who go from one defeat to another, feel that momentum is overrated and that it all boils down to how one executes their skills on a given day. There is no definitive answer on which opinion is more correct than the other. If you ask Hyderabad, one suspects, they will talk in generic terms, talking about taking it one match at a time, about not getting carried away by past results and insisting that past victories will have no bearing on future outcomes. That's perhaps a sanguine way of looking at things.

Especially with the shake-up of their bowling attack, Hyderabad have showcased the courage and bravery required to be successful in this format. Some might say their hand was forced in a way, following their less-than-ideal start to the campaign. Harshal went at 11.48 in his four bowls without taking a wicket, while Unadkat was only marginally better, his four wickets somewhat redressing an economy rate of 10.90. Hinge has blown hot and cold since his sensational debut, but Sakib has proved himself to be an effective wicket-taker (10), backing up Malinga (16 wickets, economy 9.44) quite wonderfully.

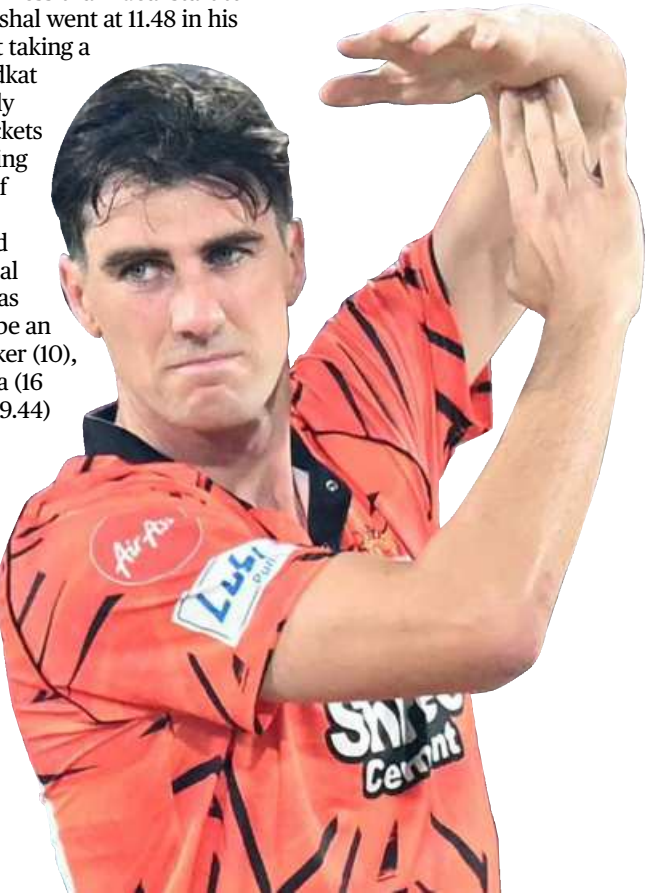
They say that batters win matches and bowlers win tournaments. Hyderabad have both disciplines ticking over beautifully. Who knows, maybe this is the year Cummins (and Kishan) emulate David Warner and take them to their second crown.

THE GIST

What makes SRH's revival even more special is the fact that they have seamlessly embraced a change in captaincy too, with Pat Cummins effortlessly slipping back into the role he has performed with aplomb in the past

The Sunrisers placing faith in Ishan Kishan was an extension of the BCCI recognising his worth, though the captaincy career with his new franchise got off to a rocky start

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HEALTH

Why are fathers missing in reproductive health interventions

A father's lifestyle, diet, exercise, exposure to stress and other factors, can programme the next generation, influencing traits in their children; yet, men are barely involved in reproductive health programmes in India; under the RMNCH+A program, male involvement remains limited to the supplementation of iron tablets to adolescent boys

C. Aravinda

India's Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child and Adolescent Health (RMNCH+A) programme has steadily reduced maternal mortality, neonatal deaths, and childhood mortality over the past three decades. Success is undeniable, when measured by survival. Yet, a quieter concern is surfacing in clinics and epidemiological data. Many children appear more vulnerable to recurrent infections, metabolic disturbances, and reduced physical robustness. The question is no longer about survival alone, but also about the biological quality of that survival. Increasingly, scientists are beginning to suspect that something fundamental may be missing in how we understand the inheritance of traits from parents.

Missing fathers

Reproductive health within the health system has traditionally focused almost exclusively on mothers. Antenatal care, maternal nutrition, and institutional deliveries form the core of national programmes. Fathers, in contrast, have largely remained outside the biological narrative. Emerging scientific evidence now suggests that this omission may not be trivial. A father's diet, lifestyle, exposure to toxins, stress and environment – long before conception – may influence the biology of the child in ways we are only beginning to understand. This shifts the conversation we need to have from a mother-centric model to a more inclusive, bi-parental understanding of health transmission.

The traditional model of reproduction is straightforward. The ovum contributes maternal genetic material, and the sperm delivers the paternal genome. The fusion of these two forms is a zygote, which develops under the guidance of DNA. In this framework, the father's role is limited to the transmission of DNA. His lifestyle choices (including whether he exercised, smoked, or lived in polluted surroundings) were believed to have no bearing on what was passed on. For over a century, this model was reinforced by August Weismann's idea of the blood-testis barrier, which held that environmental influences cannot affect germ (sperm and egg) cells. According to this view, a man's lifestyle, whether healthy or harmful, would not influence the sperm in a way that could be passed on to the next generation. The sperm was seen as a passive carrier of DNA, insulated from the external environment.

This assumption began to weaken in the early 2010s, when studies demonstrated that paternal exposures such as poor diet, alcohol consumption, and environmental toxins could influence offspring traits. These traits were not encoded in DNA changes, but appeared to be transmitted through epigenetic mechanisms. Small molecules, particularly RNA fragments in sperm, were identified as carriers of such



New findings: In India, there is no structured focus on paternal preconception health, no systematic screening for lifestyle risks among prospective fathers, and minimal emphasis on environmental exposures that may affect sperm quality. GETTY IMAGES

information. These molecules could regulate gene expression in early embryos, effectively transmitting information about the father's environment without altering the genetic code itself. This discovery marked a shift in biology, suggesting that inheritance is more dynamic than previously believed. However, one key question remained unanswered: how exactly are these signals transmitted, and how do they shape the child's biology?

New evidence

A recent study published in *Cell Metabolism* by Chinese researchers adds an important layer to this evolving story. In this study, male mice that underwent structured treadmill exercise for eight weeks produced offspring with significantly improved endurance and metabolic profiles. Quantitatively, these offspring ran longer and covered greater distances in treadmill tests, with statistically significant differences often exceeding 30% - 40% compared to offspring of sedentary fathers. Oxygen consumption measurements showed higher VO2 levels across light and dark cycles, indicating enhanced metabolic efficiency. Muscle analysis revealed a shift towards oxidative fibre types, with a notable increase in type I and type IIa fibres and a reduction in glycolytic fibres.

The most compelling contribution of the study lies in its proposed mechanism. The researchers demonstrate that paternal exercise alters the profile of sperm microRNAs, a class of small non-coding RNAs. These microRNAs are delivered to the oocyte at fertilisation and interact with early embryonic transcripts. The study suggests that microRNAs suppress nuclear receptor corepressor 1, a molecule that normally inhibits PGC-1α, a master regulator of mitochondrial

function. By relieving this inhibition, the embryo is programmed towards enhanced oxidative metabolism and mitochondrial development. The study further strengthens this causal pathway by injecting sperm-derived small RNAs from exercised fathers into normal embryos, which then reproduced similar metabolic and endurance phenotypes in offspring. It suggests that these RNA molecules are not merely markers, but active agents of inheritance.

One of the most intriguing implications concerns how these molecular signals bypass the classical Weismann barrier. The study suggests that systemic physiological states, such as increased muscular PGC-1α activity during exercise, can influence the composition of small RNAs in sperm. While the exact transport mechanism remains unclear, it is hypothesised that circulating RNA fragments or vesicle-mediated transport systems may allow signals from somatic tissues to influence germ cells. In effect, the barrier is not absolute but selectively permeable to regulatory molecules, particularly small RNAs that can re-programme gene expression without altering DNA.

During fertilisation, the sperm does more than deliver DNA. It contributes a complex molecular cargo, including proteins and RNA fragments. These molecules interact with the oocyte cytoplasm and influence the earliest stages of embryonic development.

The study highlights that sperm microRNAs can act immediately after fertilisation, modifying transcriptional networks before the embryo begins its own gene expression. This early window appears critical, as small changes in gene regulation at this stage can lead to lasting physiological differences in the offspring. Several uncertainties persist. The

precise fate of these microRNAs after fertilisation is not fully understood. It remains unclear how long they persist, which genes they consistently target, and whether their effects extend beyond the first generation. Furthermore, the findings are based entirely on animal models, and extrapolation to humans must be done cautiously. Human reproductive biology is more complex, and environmental exposures are far more variable. There is also a limited understanding of dose-response relationships, that is, how much lifestyle change is required to produce measurable effects in offspring.

What needs to be done

Even though we still don't fully understand how a father's lifestyle influences his child's biology, what is increasingly clear is that it does. This understanding however, is yet to translate into policy action.

In India, under the RMNCH+A program, male involvement remains limited to the supplementation of iron tablets to adolescent boys. There is no structured focus on paternal preconception health, no systematic screening for lifestyle risks among prospective fathers, and minimal emphasis on environmental exposures that may affect sperm quality.

Addressing lifestyle factors such as physical activity, substance use, and environmental exposures among men of reproductive age may offer a low-cost, high-impact strategy to improve population health across generations. If these findings hold true in humans, the implications are profound.

(Dr. C. Aravinda is an academic and public health physician. The views expressed are personal. aravindaaiimsjr10@hotmail.com)

THE GIST

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Wastewater surveillance revealed hidden COVID surges in Bengaluru

Afshan Yasmeen

Wastewater surveillance in Bengaluru closely tracked COVID-19 trends during the first Omicron wave, but later emerged as an important tool in identifying hidden surges that were not fully captured through routine clinical testing, according to researchers studying the city's sewage-based monitoring network.

A study published in *PLOS Global Public Health* by researchers from the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), International Centre for Theoretical Sciences (ICTS) which is a part of the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR) and Tata Institute for Genetics and Society (TIGS) found that wastewater surveillance mirrored the rise in COVID-19 cases during the Omicron wave, though it did not provide an early warning of the surge. Researchers said viral loads detected in sewage and reported infections rose almost simultaneously during that phase, limiting its usefulness as a predictive tool. However, subsequent wastewater monitoring indicated that as clinical testing declined in later phases of the pandemic, sewage surveillance became

increasingly valuable in identifying fresh waves of infection that may otherwise have gone underreported.

Four COVID-19 surges

Farah Ishtiaq, a researcher from TIGS who is one of the authors of the *PLOS* study, told *The Hindu* that Bengaluru experienced four distinct COVID-19 surges between December 2021 and April 2024. These included the BA.2.10 wave, followed by a mixed BA.2 lineage surge involving BA.4, BA.5 and BA.2.75 variants, then the XBB wave, and most recently the JN.1 surge.

"During the early phase, from December 2021 to June 2022, wastewater signals and reported clinical cases were closely aligned. That showed both surveillance systems were functioning effectively and capturing the spread of infection in the community," Dr. Ishtiaq said.

She said the situation changed from July 2022 to November 2023, when routine clinical testing declined substantially. Testing, she said, was often stepped up only after infections had already begun to rise. "That points to a reactive rather than proactive surveillance model. Wastewater monitoring, on the other hand, continued consistently and



Close study: Wastewater monitoring can become a dependable indicator of community transmission. FILE PHOTO

therefore became a more dependable indicator of community transmission," she said.

Reflection of trends

According to Dr. Ishtiaq, these trends were also reflected in a separate study in *The Lancet*, which analysed weekly wastewater monitoring data from Bengaluru. The study found that during the early phase of the Omicron period, virus levels in sewage closely matched reported

clinical cases, but later diverged as testing levels dropped. Researchers said sewage data clearly detected a major surge associated with the XBB variant in April 2023, followed by another rise linked to the JN.1 variant beginning in late December 2023. Both these waves were visible in wastewater trends but were not proportionately reflected in clinical case reporting or genomic surveillance data.

The findings, they said, underline

the importance of maintaining multiple surveillance systems, especially once public testing intensity declines after major pandemic waves. Bengaluru was among the early Indian cities to establish systematic wastewater surveillance, beginning citywide monitoring in August 2021. Samples were collected from 26 sewage treatment plants (STPs), which together process a large share of the city's wastewater.

For the *PLOS* study, researchers mapped wastewater catchment areas to 198 administrative wards under the Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike, allowing comparison of viral load data from individual STPs with ward-level case counts. The analysis focused on November 15, 2021, to January 31, 2022, covering the first Omicron wave. Using statistical tools such as Pearson correlation and change-point analysis, researchers found strong correlation – often above 0.8 – between wastewater viral loads and case counts across most treatment plants, indicating that sewage surveillance can reliably track infection trends in real time. However, the study found no robust lead time that would allow

authorities to anticipate outbreaks significantly before clinical cases increased. Apparent short leads were attributed to interpolation of weekly wastewater data rather than genuine advance warning signals.

Complementary tool

Dr. Ishtiaq said wastewater surveillance should be viewed as a complementary public health tool rather than a replacement for clinical surveillance. "By the time a strong signal appears in wastewater, it often means that a substantial number of people in the community are already infected. That is why routine clinical testing at sentinel locations remains essential for early detection and timely response," she said. She added that maintaining consistent surveillance even between waves would help cities respond earlier, prepare hospitals and reduce the impact of future outbreaks. The findings underline that while wastewater monitoring cannot substitute clinical case detection, it offers a crucial window into community transmission -particularly when routine testing systems weaken or public participation in testing declines. (yasmeen.afshan@thehindu.co.in)

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Children hospitalised after having mid-day meals in Bihar school

150 + Children fell ill after allegedly consuming mid-day meals at a government school in Bihar's Saharsa district, with over 100 admitted to the district hospital and others shifted to a local health centre. Family members of some children claimed that a snake was found in the meal, but the authorities have not made any comment on it yet. PTI

Value of narcotic tablets seized near Nepal border in U.P.

1 in ₹ crores. Uttar Pradesh Police arrested three alleged interstate smugglers and seized banned narcotic tablets worth around ₹1 crore near the India-Nepal border in Maharajganj district during an anti-narcotics operation. The police said the trio had been active in the region for the past three months and used hired vehicles to transport the banned tablets. PTI

Ex-Rajasthan minister arrested in Jal Jeevan Mission scam probe

960 in ₹ crores. Rajasthan's Anti-Corruption Bureau arrested former minister Mahesh Joshi in connection with the alleged ₹960-crore Jal Jeevan Mission scam involving fraudulent tenders and forged completion certificates, with multiple officials and contractors already under investigation. PTI

Number of passengers handled by Kochi airport during 2025-26

1.14 in crores. Cochin International Airport handled more than 1.14 crore passengers during 2025-26, marking the fourth consecutive financial year in which it crossed the 10 million passenger milestone despite disruptions linked to airline operations and tensions in West Asia. The airport also recorded over 73,000 aircraft movements during the period. PTI

Suspected mastermind arrested in fake firms and hawala racket

3,200 in ₹ crore. The Uttar Pradesh Police arrested a man accused of masterminding a network of fake firms, forged documents and suspected 'hawala' transactions worth more than ₹ 3,200 crore, with investigators probing links to GST fraud and possible terror funding. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Scope of legal fiction in party mergers

Henry Maine called legal fiction an agency by which law adapts to changing societies. In the Indian context, a 1955 ruling delineating the scope of legal fiction, reaffirmed by the Supreme Court in March, sets limits that the law on defections has yet to absorb.

LETTER AND SPIRIT

V. Venkatesan

The law has a long-standing habit of pretending: that an adopted child is the natural child of the adoptive parents, that a registered company is a person capable of suing and being sued. Sir Henry Maine, in *Ancient Law* (1861), called the legal fiction one of three great agencies, alongside equity and legislation, by which law adapts to changing societies.

The device has not been universally welcomed; historically, jurists worried that fictions allowed judges to make law in disguise. Lon Fuller, in his Stanford monograph *Legal Fictions* (1967), laid down the modern test: a fiction is honest only when its falsity is openly acknowledged; once it is “taken seriously”, once people begin to treat the pretence as fact, it loses its utility and becomes dangerous. A fiction is a tool, fashioned for a defined end, and works only within that end.

On legal fiction in India

In Indian constitutional law, the leading authority on this discipline is *Bengal Immunity Co. Ltd. vs State of Bihar* (1955), decided by a seven-judge Constitution Bench. The case concerned a Calcutta-based company that manufactured vaccines and sera and sold them to buyers in Bihar; Bihar sought to tax those sales by relying on a deeming clause then attached to Article 286(1) of the Constitution, which treated a sale as having taken place in the State where the goods were delivered for consumption. The Court rejected Bihar's argument, holding that the deeming clause served only to fix the location of a sale for one purpose and could not be stretched to override the separate constitutional bar on State taxation of inter-State trade. Acting Chief Justice S.R. Das laid down the formulation that has since governed: a legal fiction is created for a definite



In April, the Rajya Sabha Chairman accepted the merger of seven AAP MPs with BJP. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

purpose, must be limited to that purpose, and must not be extended beyond its legitimate field.

A complementary discipline came from Lord Asquith of the House of Lords in *East End Dwellings Co. Ltd. vs Finsbury Borough Council* (1952): one must imagine the necessary consequences of the fiction, but must not let imagination “boggle” beyond them. The Indian Supreme Court adopted that formulation in *J.K. Cotton Spinning and Weaving Mills Ltd. vs Union of India* (1987), confining a deeming fiction in the Central Excise Rules to its stated purpose.

That this discipline remains current was reaffirmed on March 10, 2026, in *Registrar Cane Cooperative Societies vs Gurdeep Singh Narwal* by the Supreme Court. The case concerned two sugarcane growers' cooperative societies, Bajpur and Gadarpur, whose villages had fallen partly in Uttar Pradesh and partly in Uttarakhand after the new State was carved out of Uttar Pradesh in 2000. Years later, a member of the Bajpur society argued that his society had automatically become a “Multi-State”

cooperative society on the date of bifurcation by virtue of a deeming clause in Section 103 of the Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002. Justices P.S. Narasimha and Alok Aradhe rejected the argument. The deeming fiction in Section 103 had a defined purpose: to govern societies whose stated objects extended to more than one State. It could not be extended to undo a completed reorganisation of societies whose objects were confined to a single State. The case was about cooperative societies; the principle it applied governs every deeming clause in every statute.

The merger of political parties

Among the deeming clauses of political consequence is paragraph 4(2) of the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution (on disqualification for defection). Paragraph 4 protects legislators when their original political party merges with another and two-thirds of the legislature party agree to it.

The merger of the original party is the substantive condition; the legislative threshold is the verifying count.

Paragraph 4(2) provides that a merger “shall be deemed to have taken place if, and only if” the two-thirds is met. Read against the *Bengal Immunity* case, these words tell the adjudicator how to verify a merger that has happened in the original political party, not that the legislators' assent is itself the merger.

That distinction was settled, on a parallel clause, by a 2007 Constitution Bench in *Rajendra Singh Rana vs Swami Prasad Maurya*. The argument that a legislature-party threshold could itself satisfy the substantive event in the original party would, the Court said, render one limb of the clause redundant. The court rejected it, holding further that the Speaker has no independent power under the Tenth Schedule to recognise either a split or a merger. The Punjab and Haryana High Court applied this in *Speaker, Haryana Vidhan Sabha vs Kuldeep Bishnoi* (2011): legislators alone cannot effect a merger; the original political party itself must take the substantive decision.

Recent practice, however, has allowed distortions. The Bombay High Court (Goa Bench) has twice upheld merger orders based solely on a two-thirds resolution of legislators, in 2022 and January 2025; the latter is under challenge before the Supreme Court. In April, the Rajya Sabha Chairman accepted, by administrative decision, the merger of seven Aam Aadmi Party MPs with the BJP on the same reading. A disqualification petition by the AAP has been filed. *Bengal Immunity* and *Rana*, read together, would have arrived at the opposite conclusion.

The reason is doctrinal. A deeming clause read as constitutive ceases to be a fiction. It becomes a substantive grant of power: the power of a faction of legislators to declare a merger that the parent political party has not authorised. That is the danger Fuller named and acting Chief Justice Das addressed when he confined legal fictions to their definite purpose. (V. Venkatesan is a journalist and legal researcher.)

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How does Kerala plan to tackle oil spill hazards?

What prompted the drafting of the Oil Spill Contingency Plan? How will it help protect Kerala's coastline?

G. Krishnakumar

The story so far:

Kerala had witnessed two shipwrecks off its coast involving two separate vessels – MSC Elsa 3 and MV Wan Hai 503 – on May 25, 2025 and June 9, 2025 respectively. The incidents had raised a serious threat to the State's marine ecosystem and coastal environment. The container ship MSC Elsa 3 went down with 640 containers, including 13 with hazardous cargo and 12 with calcium carbide. A large quantity of pellets, also called nurdles, had washed ashore on the southern coast following the incident. It prompted the authorities to step up efforts to formulate an Oil Spill Contingency Plan (OSCP). The Kerala State Pollution Control Board (KSPCB), which was entrusted by the government to initiate the required measures, had

awarded the work to a Bangalore-based firm. The agency submitted a report dated April 20, 2026 before the National Green Tribunal stating that the draft OSCP is ready.

Kerala has a coastal line of 590 km, and the entire coast is prone to oil spill disasters as one of the international oil transportation routes is adjacent to the State's coastal line. As per the terms of reference for preparing the OSCP, oil tankers and other ships visiting ports in the State pose a risk to the coastline areas, when they are involved in accidents. The proposal to prepare an OSCP was initiated in 2016 as part of a governmental review of the preparedness of major accident hazard units to handle chemical accidents. However, it got delayed due to various technical and financial hurdles. The scope of work included marine oil spills that occur within 12 nautical miles (24 km) of Kerala's coastline and riverine

systems extending 40 km inland or till tidal effect is evident, whichever is greater.

What are the highlights of the OSCP?

It includes mapping the Environmental Sensitive Index of oil spills along the coast of Kerala and preparing response-focussed contingency plans. The framework will elaborate on the oil spill contingency planning guidelines, wildlife response plans, ship board pollution emergency plans and tactical oil spill booming/site response plans. It will also include guidelines for crisis management and marine emergency response plans. The OSCP will highlight mitigation measures to be initiated in the wake of an emergency, the responsibilities of various departments, oil spill risks and protection priorities, shoreline response operations, and administrative action for clean-up. It will

identify areas involving operation of fishing boats and ships, and map environmentally vulnerable areas along the State's coast.

The OSCP will recommend a detailed response plan with chain of command, duties and responsibilities. It will have the contact details, list of all available resources to be pressed into service in an emergency, and the database of available machinery or equipment for clean-up operations. The Plan will highlight the steps to be taken before initiating the shoreline clean-up, including assessment of shoreline oil characteristics, on-site conditions, methods to be adopted and the scope of work required in each area as per the priorities. The KSPCB has stated that the OSCP will be prepared in accordance with the guidelines of the National Oil Disaster Contingency Plan (NOS-DCP) of 2015, 2018 and 2024.

What steps precede the final OSCP?

As per the KSPCB, the draft OSCP includes various aspects related to hydrodynamic, oil spill modelling, marine sensitivity index mapping and net environmental benefit analysis. It will be vetted by a committee of experts. The draft Plan will be submitted to the Indian Coast Guard – the central coordinating agency for combating oil pollution in the coastal and marine environment. The final OSCP will be published after receiving the required clearances.

THE GIST

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How Attenborough's imagery hid a history of colonial harm

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